

HUMAN RESOURCE DEVELOPMENT

(Open Elective)

QUESTION BANK SOLUTIONS

Full exam-style theoretical answers · 8 marks each · 60 questions

These answers are written so a reader who is new to HRD can understand the topic and then write an 8-mark answer. Each solution has a teaching introduction, eight explained points with examples, and a conclusion you can adapt in the answer book. In the exam, compress each point to about 5–8 handwritten lines.

UNIT 1 — Concept of HRD, Climate, Roles and Strategy

Question 1 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Explain the concept of Human Resource Development (HRD) and state its major objectives.

Introduction

Imagine an organisation as a living body. Machines, money and buildings are like bones and tools — they have a fixed capacity. People are different: a worker who joins as a trainee can, over years, become a supervisor, a manager, or an innovator. Human Resource Development (HRD) is the planned, continuous process by which an organisation helps its people grow in knowledge, skill, attitude and potential, and at the same time builds a culture in which people help each other.

HRD is a part of Human Resource Management, but it is not the whole of HRM. HRM also includes hiring, salary, labour laws and welfare. HRD specifically deals with learning and development. Leonard Nadler introduced the term HRD in 1969 in the United States. He defined HRD as organised learning experiences, conducted within a specified time, designed to bring about the possibility of behavioural change. In simple words: HRD is not accidental learning; it is planned teaching and practice so that people actually behave differently at work.

Prof. T.V. Rao, who developed the HRD idea strongly in India, said HRD is a process by which employees are helped in a continuous and planned way to (i) acquire or sharpen capabilities for present and future roles, (ii) develop their general capabilities and inner potential, and (iii) develop a culture of teamwork, trust and collaboration. HRD is therefore a process, not a one-day training camp. Techniques such as performance appraisal, counselling, training and organisation development are only tools to keep this process alive.

Healthy organisations use both formal HRD (classroom training, courses, planned change) and informal HRD (a boss coaching a junior). The focus of all HRD is to develop a superior workforce so that both the organisation and the individual can achieve their goals in service to customers.

Detailed points

1. Meaning and nature of HRD. HRD means developing the human side of the enterprise. It covers training after a person is hired, opportunities to learn new skills, resources that help employees do their tasks, coaching, mentoring, career development, performance management, succession planning, tuition help and organisation development. Unlike raw material, human potential is relatively unlimited — but it appears only if the organisation creates a climate that identifies, nurtures and uses that potential. If that climate is missing, even talented people remain unused.

2. Objective — capabilities for present and future roles. The first major objective is to help employees acquire or sharpen the knowledge, skills and attitudes needed for the job they do today and the job they may do tomorrow. Example: a salesman may need product knowledge today; next year the same person may need team-leading skill. HRD plans for both. Without this objective, people become outdated when technology or markets change.

3. Objective — developing inner potential and the whole person. HRD is not only ‘fix the current skill gap’. It also aims to help individuals discover talents they themselves may not have noticed — communication, problem-solving, creativity, leadership — and use them for personal growth and organisational development. This is why career talks, potential appraisal and education (not only job training) are part of HRD.

4. Objective — building a developmental culture. T.V. Rao stressed culture: strong superior–subordinate relations, teamwork and collaboration among departments, so that employees feel professional pride and motivation. If culture is political or fearful, training will not transfer to the job. So culture-building is itself an HRD objective, not a side effect.

5. Objective — equity, employability and adaptability. Notes also list equity (fair chance of training and promotion irrespective of caste, gender, language), employability (skills that keep a person valuable in the labour market), and adaptability (ability to adjust to continuous organisational change). These three make HRD socially responsible as well as business-useful.

6. Objective — development at many levels, not only the individual. HRD goals include developing: (1) each person as an individual, (2) the person in the present role, (3) the person in future roles, (4) the dyad (employee and boss), (5) team spirit in every unit, (6) collaboration across units, and (7) the organisation's overall health and self-renewing capability. A student should remember that HRD is not 'send staff to a course'; it is multi-level development.

7. Objective — enabling climate and organisational dynamism. Organisations that want to be dynamic and growth-oriented need an enabling culture — people take initiative, experiment, innovate and make things happen. Even a firm that has stopped growing still needs HRD, because the environment keeps changing. HRD's objective is stability plus renewal through people.

8. How objectives are achieved (process, not a bag of tricks). Objectives are achieved by planning HRD, allocating money and time, and living an HRD philosophy that values human beings. Mechanisms (appraisal, training, OD) must be checked periodically: are they helping development or only creating paperwork? If forms are filled but nobody learns, the mechanism is hindering the process and must be redesigned.

***Conclusion.** For the exam, define HRD (Nadler + T.V. Rao), stress that it is a continuous planned process, then write 5–7 objectives: present/future capabilities, potential, culture, equity/employability/adaptability, multi-level development, and enabling climate. Close by saying HRD develops both people and the organisation, not training alone.*

Question 2 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Describe the evolution of Human Resource Development from traditional employee training to a strategic organisational function.

Introduction

HRD did not appear overnight. It grew as industry, labour laws and competition changed. A student who knows this history can show the examiner that HRD is more than 'old training with a new name'. The story moves from welfare and record-keeping, to skill training, to a full development system, and finally to strategic HRD linked to business goals.

Detailed points

1. Welfare and personnel administration stage. In early factories, the 'people' job was welfare, attendance, discipline, wages and industrial relations. The department was often called Personnel. Development of employees was accidental. The assumption was that workers needed control, not growth. This stage created files and rules, not learning systems.

2. Training as a separate, short-term activity. Wars, mass production and scientific management created a need for job-skill training — how to operate a machine, how to follow a method. Training cells ran induction and technical courses. Learning was short, job-specific and often disconnected from promotion or strategy. If production was busy, training was cancelled. This is 'traditional employee training'.

3. Birth of the HRD concept (Nadler, 1969). Leonard Nadler argued that organisations needed organised learning for behavioural change — training, education and development as a field. HRD was named as something broader than a classroom. This was a turning point: learning became a designed experience with a time frame and a change purpose.

4. Indian HRD movement and systems view (1970s–80s). In India, scholars such as T.V. Rao and Udai Pareek at IIMA and later HRD networks treated HRD as a system: performance appraisal, potential appraisal, feedback, counselling, training, career planning and OD working together. L&T and other firms pioneered HRD departments. The idea was climate and culture, not only courses.

5. From maintenance-oriented HRM to development-oriented HRD. HRM remained responsible for staffing, pay and compliance (maintenance). HRD became the development engine. Structure also changed: HRD needed interdependence across departments, and every manager (not only the personnel officer) was made responsible for developing people.

6. Link with organisational strategy. Global competition, quality movements, IT and liberalisation forced firms to ask: what capabilities do we need next year? Training calendars copied from last year were not enough. HRD began to translate strategy into competencies, leadership pipelines and change programmes. That is strategic HRD.

7. Today's strategic HRD function. Modern HRD includes competency mapping, talent management, coaching, e-learning, knowledge management, diversity and learning-organisation work. The HRD professional sits with business heads, not only with trainers. Metrics (climate surveys, skill indices, succession cover) try to show contribution to performance.

8. What the evolution teaches an exam student. If a company still only runs isolated workshops, it is stuck in the traditional stage. Treating HRD as strategic means: diagnosis, integration of subsystems, line-manager ownership, and alignment with business goals. Evolution is therefore a change in purpose, scope, responsibility and status of the function.

***Conclusion.** Write the stages in order (personnel → training cell → Nadler/HRD system → strategic HRD), name Nadler and T.V. Rao, and end by saying HRD became strategic because people capability is now a source of competitive advantage, not a welfare extra.*

Question 3 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Explain the relationship between Human Resource Development and Human Resource Management.

Introduction

Students often treat HRM and HRD as the same subject. Examiners expect you to show both the difference and the relationship. HRM is the broader management of people at work. HRD is the developmental part (and philosophy) that sits inside or beside HRM. They are related like a whole and a specialised process: one maintains the employment system; the other grows people and climate.

Detailed points

1. HRM as the umbrella. Human Resource Management deals with procurement (recruitment and selection), development, compensation, maintenance (welfare, safety, IR) and utilisation of people. HRD is mainly the development and utilisation-through-growth part of this list. So HRD is generally treated as a subset or a specialised system within HRM, not a rival department fighting HRM.

2. Maintenance versus development orientation. A standard distinction in the notes: HRM is mainly maintenance-oriented — keep the organisation staffed, paid, legally safe and reasonably satisfied. HRD is development-oriented — change behaviour, raise competence, build culture. Example: processing leave and salary is HRM maintenance; a six-month coaching plan after appraisal is HRD.

3. Aims compared. HRM aims at efficient use of employees (the right number of people doing the job at the right cost). HRD aims at development of employees and of the organisation as a whole. Efficiency without

development becomes short-term; development without basic HRM (fair pay, clear jobs) cannot start.

4. Structure and responsibility. HRM structure is often an independent personnel department. HRD creates inter-dependent structures because development cuts across sales, production and finance. Responsibility for HRM often sits with the HR manager; responsibility for HRD is given to all managers at all levels, with specialists only facilitating. This is a favourite exam point.

5. Motivation tools. HRM frequently motivates through monetary incentives, bonuses and welfare. HRD stresses higher-order needs — achievement, recognition, learning, self-actualisation — through challenging work, feedback and career growth. Both are needed: money prevents dissatisfaction; development creates commitment.

6. How they depend on each other. Without HRM, HRD has no stable workforce to develop (wrong hiring, unfair pay, constant strikes). Without HRD, HRM cannot upgrade the quality of human resources; people remain as they were on the day of joining. Appraisal data from HRM feeds HRD training plans; HRD results improve HRM outcomes such as promotion quality and retention.

7. Strategic HRM uses HRD as a lever. Modern strategic HRM says people are a competitive resource. That strategy is implemented through HRD systems — competencies, learning, leadership. So the relationship is not only ‘subset’; HRD is the engine that makes strategic HRM real.

8. Practical example. A bank hires probationary officers (HRM procurement), pays them as per scale (HRM compensation), and must follow labour law (HRM maintenance). HRD then runs induction, on-the-job coaching, role-based training, potential appraisal for future branch managers, and counselling. If any one side is weak, either people leave or they stay unskilled.

Conclusion. End with: HRM and HRD are complementary. HRM provides the employment framework; HRD develops people within that framework. Do not write that they are identical, and do not write that they are unrelated.

Question 4 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Discuss the importance of HRD in improving individual and organisational performance.

Introduction

Performance means achieving desired results — for an employee (quality, quantity, behaviour) and for the organisation (profit, service, survival, reputation). HRD improves performance not by shouting ‘work harder’, but by raising ability, motivation, role clarity and teamwork. The notes say human resources have unlimited potential if a climate exists to use it. That is why HRD is important for performance.

Detailed points

1. Ability: closing the skill gap. A simple formula in training literature is: Training need = Standard performance – Actual performance, when the cause is lack of knowledge/skill. HRD identifies this gap and provides learning. A machine operator who is trained on a new CNC machine produces more with fewer defects. Individual performance rises first; organisational output follows.

2. Role clarity through appraisal and feedback. Many people perform poorly because they do not know what ‘good’ looks like. Developmental appraisal and counselling clarify goals and behaviours. When a teacher or a sales executive receives specific feedback, effort is directed, not wasted. Clear roles reduce conflict and rework, which are hidden performance killers.

3. Motivation and morale. HRD satisfies higher-order needs. Employees who see a future, receive coaching and are treated with dignity show more discretionary effort — they do more than the minimum. Notes list benefits of training and development: higher job satisfaction, motivation, lower turnover. Motivated people sustain performance; frightened people only show short bursts.

4. Using potential, not only present skill. Potential appraisal and career planning place people where they can contribute more. Promoting or rotating the right person improves organisational performance (better decisions) and individual performance (person–job fit). Ignoring potential wastes human capital — the organisation pays a salary but uses 50% of the person.

5. Team and collaboration effects. Organisational performance is not the sum of isolated individuals. HRD develops dyads (boss–subordinate) and teams so that coordination improves. Quality circles, group learning and OD reduce inter-department blame. A hospital’s performance, for example, depends on nurses, doctors and labs working as a system — that is HRD culture.

6. Adaptability, innovation and customer service. In a changing environment, yesterday’s high performance becomes today’s failure. HRD creates an enabling culture where people experiment and learn. That improves innovation, adoption of technology and service to customers — the notes say HRD’s focus is a superior workforce serving customers.

7. Reducing negative performance drains. Errors, accidents, absenteeism and attrition destroy performance. HRD (safety training, counselling, career paths) reduces these. It is cheaper to develop people than to keep replacing them. Organisational performance therefore improves through cost saved as well as output gained.

8. Strategic, long-term performance. Short-term pressure can raise numbers by overtime or fear. HRD builds long-term performance: leadership pipeline, self-renewing organisation, and a climate that continues after one manager leaves. That is organisational effectiveness, not a one-quarter spike.

***Conclusion.** In the exam, connect individual performance (skill, feedback, motivation, fit) to organisational performance (teamwork, innovation, lower waste, strategy). HRD is important because people — unlike machines — can grow, and performance grows with them if climate and systems support learning.*

Question 5 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Explain the concept of HRD climate and identify the major characteristics of a supportive HRD climate.

Introduction

Climate means the ‘weather’ of the workplace — how it feels to work here now. Organisational climate is the general atmosphere. HRD climate is the part of that atmosphere which tells employees whether this place values learning, trust, openness and development. You cannot see climate like you see a machine, but you can feel it: Do I dare to ask a doubt? Will my boss help me grow? Are mistakes used for learning or for punishment?

Indian HRD writing (Pareek, Rao and others) often describes a supportive climate through values such as OCTAPAC: Openness, Confrontation, Trust, Autonomy, Proactivity, Authenticity and Collaboration. A supportive HRD climate is the soil; HRD techniques are the seeds. Seeds fail in dead soil.

Detailed points

1. Concept — perceived developmental atmosphere. HRD climate is the set of employee perceptions about how much the organisation supports their development. It includes top-management’s interest in people, personnel policies, and the behaviour of bosses. If policies say ‘we are a learning organisation’ but bosses shout at questions, the climate is poor — perception, not posters, is climate.

2. Openness. People can share ideas, feelings and information without fear. Communication is two-way. Example: in a meeting a junior can say ‘this target is unrealistic’ and is heard, not labelled as negative. Closed climate produces silence and fake agreement.

3. Trust and authenticity. Employees believe that management’s words match actions. People behave genuinely rather than playing politics. Trust is needed for honest appraisal and counselling; without it, feedback is seen as a

trap. Authenticity means not wearing a mask at work.

4. Confrontation of problems (not avoidance). Problems are brought to the table and solved. A supportive climate does not mean ‘be nice and hide issues’. It means issues are discussed with respect. Example: quality defects are analysed, not buried. Avoidance climate looks peaceful but performance slowly dies.

5. Autonomy and proactivity. Employees have reasonable freedom to plan their work and are encouraged to take initiative, experiment and act before being told. Over-control kills HRD climate because people wait for orders and never develop judgement — which is a key capability.

6. Collaboration and teamwork. Help-seeking and help-giving across sections is normal. Departments do not treat each other as enemies. Collaboration is both a characteristic of climate and an objective of HRD culture in T.V. Rao’s definition.

7. Top-management support and fair developmental practices. Leaders spend time and money on development, release people for training, and model learning. Appraisal, training chances and careers are seen as fair, not reserved for favourites. Recognition is given for learning and mentoring, not only for short-term numbers.

8. Why these characteristics matter. If these features exist, training transfers to the job, people admit skill gaps, and potential comes to the surface. If they do not, HRD mechanisms become rituals. Therefore identifying characteristics is not a memory list — it is a diagnostic tool for any organisation.

***Conclusion.** Define HRD climate as the felt support for development; list OCTAPAC-type characteristics with one line of meaning each; end by saying a supportive climate is a prerequisite for HRD effectiveness.*

Question 6 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Differentiate between HRD climate and organisational culture with suitable examples.

Introduction

Culture and climate are related but not twins. Students who mix them lose marks. Organisational culture is the deep, shared way of life of the organisation — values, beliefs, assumptions, rituals, stories and heroes. HRD climate is the current, felt atmosphere specifically about development, trust and learning. Culture is ‘who we are over years’. Climate is ‘how developmental it feels this year’.

Detailed points

1. Definition difference. Culture: shared values and taken-for-granted assumptions (e.g., ‘elders decide’, ‘customer is king’, ‘never question the owner’). HRD climate: employees’ perception of openness, support for training, fairness of appraisal, and boss’s coaching behaviour. Climate can be surveyed with questionnaires more easily than deep culture.

2. Depth. Culture is deep and often unconscious. People may not even know they hold a value until a newcomer breaks an unwritten rule. Climate is more surface and conscious: ‘My manager does not send me to training.’ You can describe climate in a week; you need longer to understand culture.

3. Stability and speed of change. Culture changes slowly — sometimes over a generation. HRD climate can improve or worsen in months if a new leader coaches, or if a new appraisal system is misused. Example: after a merger, climate may crash immediately (fear) while the old cultures of both firms still live underneath.

4. Scope. Culture covers everything: power, dress, humour, who gets a cabin, how festivals are celebrated. HRD climate is narrower: learning, feedback, collaboration, growth opportunities. All HRD climate is part of organisational experience, but not all culture is HRD climate.

5. Example of culture. A traditional family business may have a paternalistic culture: loyalty, seniority, the owner as father. People stay long years. That is culture. It may be warm or controlling, but it is a shared identity.

6. Example of HRD climate inside that culture. In the same family firm, if seniors patiently teach juniors, admit mistakes, and sponsor IT courses, HRD climate is supportive. If seniors hide knowledge so that juniors cannot replace them, HRD climate is poor — even though the ‘family culture’ looks the same from outside.

7. Mismatch example (stated culture vs felt climate). A software company prints ‘We are a learning culture’ on the wall. In reality, people who attend training are given extra work as punishment, and appraisals only rank forced percentages. Culture-talk is fake; HRD climate is hostile. Employees become cynical.

8. Implication for HRD practice. HRD interventions must respect culture (do not copy a Western 360-degree tool blindly into a highly hierarchical culture without preparation) while deliberately improving climate (more coaching, safer feedback). Ignoring culture makes climate programmes cosmetic; ignoring climate makes culture statements empty.

Conclusion. In the exam, draw a small contrast table in words: culture = deep values, slow, broad; HRD climate = current developmental atmosphere, faster to change, specific. Give one matching and one mismatch example. Conclude that HRD succeeds when both are understood.

Question 7 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Explain the role and responsibilities of an HRD professional in an organisation.

Introduction

An HRD professional is not a clerk who books a hall and orders tea for a training programme. He or she is a specialist who designs systems so that people develop, and a partner who helps managers develop their teams. As organisations moved from personnel administration to strategic HRD, this role became broader: diagnostician, designer, facilitator, change agent and evaluator.

Detailed points

1. Diagnosing development needs. The professional studies performance data, climate surveys, strategy and skill inventories to find gaps at organisation, job and person levels. Without diagnosis, HRD becomes a catalogue of fashionable workshops. Responsibility includes telling management when the problem is not training (e.g., broken machines) so money is not wasted.

2. Designing the HRD system. Role includes structuring performance appraisal, potential appraisal, training, career planning, feedback and counselling so they work as one system. Isolated tools fail. The professional writes policies, designs forms that actually help conversation, and sequences the annual HRD cycle.

3. Facilitating learning. The HRD person may train, but more often enables learning: choosing methods, developing internal trainers, arranging mentoring, e-learning and on-the-job projects. Informal coaching by managers is also HRD; the professional must help managers become coaches.

4. Culture and climate builder. Responsibility to promote openness, trust, collaboration — through OD exercises, communication forums, and by advising leaders on their own behaviour. If the CEO publicly humiliates staff, the HRD professional must have the courage to name the climate damage.

5. Advisor and change agent. During technology change, merger, quality drive or restructuring, people feel fear and skill shock. The HRD professional prepares them, manages resistance, and redesigns roles. This is a consulting role, not an administrative one.

6. Developing line managers as developers. Notes stress that HRD is every manager's job. The professional trains bosses in appraisal discussion, feedback and counselling, and holds them accountable for team development. If line managers refuse, HRD remains a peripheral cell.

7. Evaluation, audit and ethics. The role includes checking whether mechanisms help or hinder development (HRD audit), measuring training at more than smile-sheet level, and protecting fairness and confidentiality in counselling. An unethical HRD professional who leaks appraisal gossip destroys climate.

8. Competencies required. To do all this, the professional needs knowledge of learning theory, organisation behaviour, business basics, facilitation skill, and integrity. The role has shifted from 'training administrator' to 'human capital architect'.

***Conclusion.** List roles with a line of explanation: diagnostician, system designer, learning facilitator, climate builder, change agent, developer of managers, evaluator. End: the HRD professional succeeds when managers develop people daily, not when the training calendar looks full.*

Question 8 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Discuss the significance of HRD for achieving organisational effectiveness and long-term employee development.

Introduction

Organisational effectiveness means the organisation achieves its goals, satisfies stakeholders, adapts to the environment and remains healthy inside. Long-term employee development means people keep growing in capability and career over years, not only in one induction week. HRD is significant because these two outcomes are joined: an organisation cannot stay effective for long with undeveloped people, and people cannot develop for long in an ineffective, stagnant organisation.

Detailed points

1. Competence as the engine of effectiveness. Goals (quality, cost, service) are achieved through what people can do. HRD continuously upgrades competence. A hospital, a college or a factory is effective only if staff can perform current technology and standards. Effectiveness is therefore a people outcome, not only a finance outcome.

2. Enabling culture and self-renewal. Notes say even organisations that have reached a growth limit must adapt. HRD builds self-renewing mechanisms — learning from mistakes, scanning the environment, updating skills. That is organisational health, a dimension of effectiveness.

3. Alignment of individual effort with organisational goals. Long-term development is wasted if it is random. HRD links individual development plans to strategy so that when the firm needs digital skills or customer focus, people are being developed in that direction. Alignment makes both the person and the firm effective.

4. Leadership pipeline and succession. Effectiveness tomorrow depends on who leads then. Career planning, potential appraisal and mentoring create a pipeline. Without HRD, retirement or resignation of a few key people collapses effectiveness. Long-term employee development is the method; organisational continuity is the result.

5. Employee growth beyond the present job. Long-term development includes general capabilities — judgement, human relations, conceptual skill — not only today's task. This prepares people for higher roles and also makes them more employable. Employees who grow stay committed; that commitment feeds effectiveness.

6. Retention, morale and reduced human wastage. Turnover, inner resignation and under-use of talent are enemies of effectiveness. HRD significance lies in offering a future, fairness and learning, which retain people. Replacing staff is costly and destroys team memory.

7. Humanistic plus economic value. HRD treats people as assets with unlimited potential. This is ethically significant (people first, equity, dignity) and economically significant (human capital). Examiners like this dual justification.

8. Without HRD, both suffer. If HRD is treated as a cost to cut, training stops, climate becomes fearful, high performers leave, and the organisation may look profitable for a short time but loses effectiveness. Significance is therefore preventive as well as positive.

Conclusion. Write that HRD is significant because organisational effectiveness is produced by capable, motivated, collaborating people, and long-term employee development is how those people are created and retained. The two aims are one process.

Question 9 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

A growing organisation is facing skill gaps and declining employee performance. Suggest an HRD-oriented approach to address these issues.

Introduction

This is an application question. Do not write ‘conduct training’ as the only sentence. An HRD-oriented approach means: diagnose first, fix climate, use all subsystems (appraisal, counselling, training, career), involve line managers, and evaluate. A growing organisation has extra pressure — new markets, more staff, stretched supervisors — so skill gaps and falling performance often appear together.

Detailed points

- 1. Diagnose before prescribing.** Collect facts: which jobs, which errors, new vs old employees, whether tools and processes are adequate. Use organisation–task–person analysis. If the real cause is overloaded systems or unclear strategy, training will not help. HRD honesty starts here.
- 2. Restore or build HRD climate.** In a growing firm, bosses are busy and become short-tempered. Fear hides skill gaps. Create psychological safety: mistakes discussed, questions allowed. Without climate, people will not admit they cannot do the new work.
- 3. Developmental performance appraisal, not punishment.** Use appraisal to name specific gaps and agree improvement plans. Declining performance should trigger counselling, not only a low rating. Ratings without help increase decline.
- 4. Targeted learning mix.** From TNA, design on-the-job coaching for practical skills, short formal programmes for new technology, and buddy systems for new hires. Growing organisations should not copy a 5-day generic ‘motivation’ workshop.
- 5. Strengthen the boss as coach.** Train supervisors in feedback and coaching. In growth, many supervisors are recently promoted experts who never learned to develop others. This is often the hidden cause of team skill gaps.
- 6. Career and potential for a growing structure.** Growth creates new roles. Map who can fill them; start developing before the gap becomes a crisis. Skill gaps are partly ‘we grew faster than we developed people’.
- 7. Quick wins plus system fix.** Fix urgent error-producing skill gaps first (safety, customer, quality), then install a yearly HRD cycle so the problem does not return. Growing firms need both firefighting and a system.
- 8. Evaluate and iterate.** Measure whether errors fall, productivity recovers, and employees feel more capable. If not, return to diagnosis. HRD is a process without a full stop.

Conclusion. Frame the answer as a step-by-step HRD approach: diagnose → climate → developmental appraisal/counselling → need-based training and coaching → career for growth roles → evaluate. Show you will

not treat HRD as a single training event.

Question 10 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Apply the concept of HRD climate to suggest measures for creating a learning-oriented work environment.

Introduction

A learning-oriented work environment is a workplace where people continuously learn from work, from each other and from planned programmes, and then apply learning. In HRD language, this is a supportive HRD climate made visible in daily life. Measures must change experience, not only issue a circular ‘please learn’.

Detailed points

- 1. Leadership modelling.** Top managers should share their own learning, admit errors, and ask questions. If the head never attends a development discussion, juniors conclude learning is for the weak. Climate follows the leader.
- 2. Psychological safety.** Allow doubts, experiments and reporting of failures without humiliation. Example: a weekly ‘what we learned from defects’ meeting that never names-and-shames. Safety is the first climate brick.
- 3. Frequent developmental feedback.** Replace only-annual judgement with monthly coaching. Feedback should be specific and two-way. This is openness and confrontation of issues in OCTAPAC language.
- 4. Time, money and tools for learning.** Give learning hours, budget, access to e-learning or a small library, and permission to practise new methods on the job. Climate without resources is hypocrisy.
- 5. Team learning structures.** After-action reviews, quality circles, mentoring pairs, cross-functional projects. Collaboration characteristic of climate becomes a timetable, not a slogan.
- 6. Fair access.** Training and stretch assignments for all eligible people, not only for those close to the boss. Equity is an HRD objective and a climate signal.
- 7. Recognition of learning and teaching.** Praise and, where suitable, reward knowledge sharing and mentoring. If only individual sales heroes are rewarded, nobody will teach others.
- 8. Align HR systems.** Appraisal, promotion and job design should value coaching, teamwork and improvement. Otherwise the climate message of learning is cancelled by the climate message of ‘hit this month’s number only’.

Conclusion. *List practical measures under climate headings (openness, trust, support, fairness, collaboration). End: a learning environment is HRD climate in action; posters cannot create it, daily leadership and systems can.*

Question 11 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

State any two objectives of Human Resource Development.

Introduction

The question says ‘any two’, but it carries 8 marks in this bank, so you must (a) state two main objectives clearly, (b) explain each with meaning and example, and (c) briefly mention related objectives so the answer has depth. Use T.V. Rao’s three-fold process as the safest source.

Detailed points

- 1. Objective 1 — Acquire or sharpen capabilities for present and future roles.** Employees must be helped, continuously and in a planned way, to learn the knowledge, skills and attitudes required for the job they hold now

and the job they may hold later. Example: a nurse learns current ward procedures and also infection-control skills needed when the hospital adds an ICU. This objective keeps performance from collapsing when work changes.

2. Explanation of objective 1. This is not a one-time induction. Capabilities become blunt with new technology, customers and standards; they must be sharpened. HRD uses training, job rotation, coaching and education. If this objective is ignored, the organisation pays people who cannot do tomorrow's work.

3. Objective 2 — Develop general capabilities and inner potential. HRD also aims to help people grow as human beings — discover talents, confidence, judgement — for their own development and for the organisation. Example: a quiet technician with analytical talent is given project exposure and becomes a process-improvement leader. Potential unused is a loss to both sides.

4. Explanation of objective 2. General capabilities (communication, problem-solving, ethics, learning how to learn) travel with the person across roles. This is why HRD is broader than job training. Development activities are often longer-term and partly driven by the person's ambition, with organisational support.

5. Related objective — culture of teamwork and collaboration. T.V. Rao's third pillar: develop a culture in which boss-subordinate relations, teamwork and collaboration among units are strong, creating motivation and professional pride. You may present this as a third objective if time allows.

6. Related — equity, employability, adaptability. Notes also mention equity (fair chance for all), employability (skills that keep a person employable), and adaptability to change. These show the social and future-oriented face of HRD.

7. Related — multi-level development. Objectives also cover dyads, teams, departments and organisational self-renewal, not only individuals. Stating this proves you read the full concept.

8. How to present 'any two' in 8 marks. Write two objectives as headings, half a page each, with definition + example + how HRD achieves them. Add a short paragraph of 'other important objectives'. Never stop after two one-line sentences.

Conclusion. Best pair to remember: (1) role-related capabilities for present and future work; (2) development of potential and a collaborative culture. Explain, illustrate, then close.

Question 12 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

State any two ways in which HRD and HRM are related.

Introduction

Again, 'any two' for 8 marks means explain fully. Relation means how they connect, not only how they differ. First state two relations, then support with differences so the examiner sees conceptual clarity.

Detailed points

1. Relation 1 — HRD is the developmental core within HRM. HRM includes procurement, development, compensation, maintenance and utilisation. HRD is the systematic process of bringing desired behaviour change and growth. So they are related as whole and part: every complete HRM function must contain HRD, otherwise HRM only hires and pays undeveloped people.

2. Illustration of relation 1. Recruitment (HRM) selects a graduate; HRD then inducts, trains and careers that graduate. Selection quality and development quality together produce performance. Isolated HRM hiring without HRD leads to 'we hired talent but it never grew'.

3. Relation 2 — They complement each other's aims. HRM maintains the employment relationship (pay, law, staffing). HRD develops competence and climate. Fair pay (HRM) makes employees ready to learn; learning

(HRD) makes the payroll productive. They are two sides of managing people.

4. Shared concern and shared data. Both deal with human resources. Appraisal files, manpower plans and transfer policies (HRM systems) become inputs to training and succession (HRD). This information link is a practical relation.

5. Shared responsibility with line managers. Modern HRM and HRD both fail if only the HR department works. Line managers implement HRM rules and also coach (HRD). This common dependence on line managers is a relationship.

6. Strategic link. Strategic HRM treats people as a competitive resource; that strategy is executed through HRD (capability building). Thus HRD is how strategic HRM is delivered.

7. Differences that still show relation. HRM is more maintenance-oriented, HRD more development-oriented; HRM often uses money to motivate, HRD uses growth needs; HRM may be a separate department, HRD is every manager's job. Differences define the boundary of the relationship; they do not cancel it.

8. Exam presentation. Write two relations as full paragraphs, then a small contrast (4–5 lines), then a concluding sentence that they are interdependent.

***Conclusion.** Two safe relations: (1) HRD is the development function within HRM; (2) HRM conditions and HRD growth complement each other and share data, line managers and strategy. Do not only list differences.*

Question 13 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Analyse how a weak HRD climate can affect employee behaviour and organisational performance.

Introduction

Analyse means show cause → mechanism → effect. Weak HRD climate means low trust, closed communication, little support for learning, unfair development chances, and fear. Such climate changes how people behave; behaviour then damages performance. This is not a 'soft' topic; it is a performance analysis.

Detailed points

1. Fear, silence and hiding mistakes. When people expect punishment, they hide errors and stop asking questions. Problems grow until they explode (customer crisis, accident). Organisational performance suffers through late discovery of issues.

2. Low initiative and learned helplessness. Without autonomy and support, employees wait for orders. Proactivity — a feature of enabling culture — dies. The organisation becomes slow and over-dependent on a few bosses. In a changing market this is fatal.

3. Training without transfer. Even expensive programmes fail because the workplace does not allow new methods. People return from training and are told 'forget that, do it the old way'. Behaviour does not change; training budget is wasted; performance stays flat.

4. Defensive and political appraisal behaviour. In a weak climate, ratings become weapons. Employees manage impressions, not work. Honest feedback is absent, so individuals cannot improve. Average organisational performance is mis-measured and mis-managed.

5. Broken collaboration. Units protect their boundaries, blame others, and refuse to share knowledge. Team performance and decision quality fall. Customers see delays and contradictions.

6. Demotivation, withdrawal and turnover. Higher-order needs are blocked. People do the minimum, stay absent, or leave. Those who stay may be the less marketable. Human capital quality declines, dragging

performance down.

7. Unused potential. Capabilities are neither identified nor used. The firm pays for unused talent. Growth plans fail because internally nobody is ready — a direct performance constraint.

8. Combined performance effect. Put together: more errors, less innovation, weak service, high cost of attrition, poor strategy implementation. Weak HRD climate is therefore a structural cause of organisational under-performance, not merely ‘low morale’ as a feeling.

Conclusion. Structure the analysis: weak climate → fear/silence, no initiative, no transfer, politics, silos, exit → lower quality, speed, innovation and human capital. End with: fix climate or other HRD tools will fail.

Question 14 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Analyse the changing role of an HRD professional as organisations move from traditional personnel administration toward strategic human resource development.

Introduction

Analyse the shift in role along several dimensions: from what to what, why the change happened, and what new competencies are needed. Traditional personnel work was administrative. Strategic HRD work is diagnostic, integrative and business-linked.

Detailed points

- 1. From record-keeper to diagnostician.** Earlier: maintain service books, training attendance, holiday lists. Now: analyse capability versus strategy, climate data and performance trends. The professional must ask ‘what people problem is blocking the business?’
- 2. From classroom organiser to learning architect.** Booking a guest lecture is old role. New role designs blended learning: OJT, coaching, e-learning, projects. Learning is a system, not an event.
- 3. From isolated training cell to integrator of subsystems.** Strategic HRD connects appraisal, potential, career, counselling and OD. The professional’s role is to make these talk to each other, which personnel clerks never did.
- 4. Business literacy and seat at the strategy table.** The HRD person must understand products, customers and competition enough to translate strategy into competencies. Role includes advising top management, not waiting for a training request from a department.
- 5. Change agent.** Mergers, digitalisation, quality and restructuring are people processes. The new role facilitates change, deals with resistance and redesigns culture — far beyond issuing transfer orders.
- 6. Partner who develops line managers.** Personnel often did things to employees. Strategic HRD does things with managers, making every boss a developer. The professional’s success is measured by managers’ coaching quality.
- 7. Accountability with metrics.** New role uses evaluation and HRD audit, not ‘number of programmes conducted’. This is uncomfortable but necessary for strategic status.
- 8. Why the change and remaining tension.** Competition and the idea of human capital forced the change. Tension remains: many organisations still want the old clerk plus a fashionable title. Analysis should note that the role changes fully only when top management treats HRD as strategic.

Conclusion. Show a clear before–after analysis of the role, give reasons (environment, strategy, human capital), and close with required new competencies: consulting, facilitation, business understanding, ethics.

Question 15 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Analyse the relationship among HRD philosophy, HRD climate, and organisational performance.

Introduction

These three form a chain. Philosophy is what leaders believe about people. Climate is what employees feel. Performance is what the organisation achieves. Analysis should show how one produces the next, and how they can also fail together.

Detailed points

- 1. HRD philosophy defined.** Philosophy is the belief that people have potential, deserve development, and that developing them is a managerial duty — not a cost to cut when profits dip. It values human beings. Without philosophy, HRD tools are copied from other companies without conviction.
- 2. Philosophy shapes practices.** If leaders truly believe the philosophy, appraisal becomes developmental, time is released for learning, and counselling is real. If philosophy is only in the annual report, practices remain punitive. Practices are philosophy made visible.
- 3. Practices create climate.** Employees do not read philosophy booklets; they experience bosses. Consistent developmental practices produce perceptions of openness, trust and support — HRD climate. Inconsistent practices produce cynicism.
- 4. Climate shapes behaviour.** Supportive climate → initiative, learning, collaboration, honest reporting of problems. Weak climate → fear, hiding, minimum work. Behaviour is the bridge to results.
- 5. Behaviour produces performance.** Quality, productivity, innovation, customer satisfaction and adaptability improve when behaviour is enabling. Thus philosophy, through climate and behaviour, reaches organisational performance.
- 6. Reverse loops.** Good performance can confirm philosophy ('investment in people paid off') and strengthen climate. Bad performance with impatient leadership can kill HRD budgets, worsening climate and causing a downward spiral.
- 7. Inconsistency as the analytical key.** The dangerous case is high-sounding philosophy + weak climate. Employees hear 'people are our greatest asset' and see the opposite. Trust collapses more than if nothing was promised. Performance then suffers from cynicism.
- 8. Implication.** To improve performance, do not start with a poster. Start with philosophy that leaders will live, then practices, then climate. Measuring only performance and ignoring climate misleads management.

Conclusion. Draw the chain: Philosophy → practices → HRD climate → employee behaviour → organisational performance, with feedback loops. Warn that slogans without climate destroy performance.

Question 16 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Evaluate whether HRD should be treated as a strategic function rather than only as an employee training activity.

Introduction

Evaluate means give arguments for, arguments against or limitations, and a reasoned judgement. The question is almost inviting you to support strategic HRD, but a good answer also says training remains important as a tool.

Detailed points

- 1. What ‘only training’ means.** Training is planned learning for job skills, usually short-term. It is necessary. Treating HRD as only training means: calendar of courses, attendance sheets, no link to appraisal, career, climate or strategy.
- 2. Arguments for strategic HRD.** Capability, leadership pipeline, culture and change readiness decide competitive advantage. These are board-level issues. Nadler and Rao already defined HRD more widely than instruction. Evolution of the field supports strategic status.
- 3. Failure of the training-only view.** Popular courses can have high smile-sheet scores and zero job change if climate and strategy are ignored. Skill gaps in a growing firm need systems, not one workshop. Therefore training-only is too narrow for organisational effectiveness.
- 4. Counter-arguments / limits.** Small firms may only need basic skill training. Calling every training ‘strategic’ without data is empty fashion. Strategic status must be earned by diagnosis, integration and results, not by renaming the training cell.
- 5. Training still has a place.** Evaluation should not insult training. Training is a core HRD subsystem. The judgement is about nesting training inside a strategic system, not abolishing it.
- 6. Criteria for the judgement.** Ask: Does people capability affect long-term success? Yes. Can isolated training build that capability reliably? No. Therefore HRD should be strategic.
- 7. What treating HRD as strategic implies.** Seat in strategy discussions, line-manager accountability, integrated subsystems, budget as investment, evaluation at behaviour and results levels.
- 8. Final evaluative sentence.** Yes, HRD should be a strategic function; employee training is a vital instrument of that function, not the whole function.

Conclusion. Give a balanced evaluation and a clear verdict: *strategic HRD with training inside it, not training instead of HRD.*

Question 17 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Identify any two indicators of a supportive HRD climate.

Introduction

Indicators are visible or reportable signs. For 8 marks, name two, explain how you would see them, and add other valid indicators so the answer is complete.

Detailed points

- 1. Indicator 1 — Openness and free, useful feedback.** People speak in meetings, ask doubts, and receive regular specific feedback. You hear two-way conversation, not only downward orders. Suggestion schemes are actually used.
- 2. How to observe indicator 1.** Climate survey items on ‘I can discuss problems with my boss’; observation of meetings; employees not waiting for annual appraisal to know where they stand.
- 3. Indicator 2 — Visible management support for development.** Time, budget and sponsorship for learning exist. Bosses release staff for training and discuss development in reviews. Leaders themselves attend learning events.
- 4. How to observe indicator 2.** Training days per employee, percentage of IDPs completed, whether production pressure always cancels learning (if it does, support is fake).

5. Other indicators you may add. Trust, authenticity, autonomy, collaboration, confrontation of problems, fairness of opportunity, proactivity, recognition of mentors.

6. Teamwork as indicator. Cross-unit help, low hostility, joint problem-solving meetings.

7. Fairness as indicator. Women, juniors, and distant-branch staff also get development chances.

8. Exam caution. Do not only name OCTAPAC words; show behavioural signs. Indicators must be observable, not slogans.

***Conclusion.** Two strong indicators: open feedback culture, and real management support for learning. Explain signs, mention 2–3 more, conclude that indicators help diagnose climate.*

Question 18 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

State any two reasons why an HRD professional needs to understand organisational culture.

Introduction

Culture is the context of all HRD work. Two main reasons: fit of interventions, and realistic change. Expand each and add supporting reasons for 8 marks.

Detailed points

1. Reason 1 — To design interventions that fit. Appraisal, 360-degree feedback, outdoor training or open confrontation workshops can succeed or fail depending on values of hierarchy, face-saving, and power. A culture-blind copy of a foreign tool creates resistance. Understanding culture is professional competence, not extra knowledge.

2. Example for reason 1. In a highly hierarchical culture, sudden public peer feedback may be seen as insult. The professional may start with private coaching and boss-supported feedback first.

3. Reason 2 — To read climate and change realistically. Climate survey scores must be interpreted against culture. ‘Low openness’ in a military-like culture means something different from the same score in a start-up. Culture knowledge tells what can change this year and what needs a longer journey.

4. Communication and legitimacy. Messages about development must use the organisation’s language, stories and respected persons. Culture tells who must sponsor HRD (owner, union, professional CEO) for it to be legitimate.

5. Power and subcultures. Functions, regions and generations may have subcultures. One-size HRD harms inclusion. Understanding culture includes understanding these pockets.

6. Strategy and desired culture. If strategy needs innovation, HRD must know whether present culture punishes mistakes. Gap analysis between present and desired culture guides development of new behaviours.

7. Ethics. Imposing a culture by force through HRD tools can harm people. Understanding existing culture is also respect.

8. Exam close. Two reasons: (1) fit and acceptability of HRD tools; (2) diagnosis and paced culture change. Then mention communication, power, strategy.

***Conclusion.** HRD without culture knowledge is technically neat and socially blind. That is why the professional must understand culture.*

Question 19 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Evaluate the likely consequences of implementing HRD practices without considering the existing organisational culture and climate.

Introduction

Evaluate likely consequences — mostly negative — and say under what rare conditions some practice might still help. This is a judgement question.

Detailed points

- 1. Rejection and fake data.** Forced openness in a fear climate produces fake 360-degree ratings and silent classrooms. The practice exists on paper and lies in reality.
- 2. Ritualism.** Appraisal forms and training attendance are completed because they are compulsory. No behavioural change. HRD becomes a ritual, wasting time.
- 3. Cynicism and worse trust.** Employees conclude management is hypocritical. Trust, which is the heart of climate, falls further. Consequence is worse than doing nothing.
- 4. Wasted resources.** High spend, no transfer. Opportunity cost: the same money could have trained bosses in coaching aligned with culture.
- 5. Value conflict and stress.** New HRD values (autonomy, confrontation) clash with old culture (obedience, avoidance). Employees face role stress: punished if they speak, blamed if they do not develop.
- 6. Politics and inequity.** Without climate fairness, new ‘development opportunities’ are captured by in-groups. HRD increases inequality.
- 7. Possible short-term optics.** A glossy programme may impress visitors or accreditation teams. Evaluation at behaviour and results levels will still fail. Optics are not effectiveness.
- 8. Judgement.** Consequences are predominantly negative. HRD must be sequenced: diagnose culture/climate, adapt tools, build safety, then deepen practices. Blind implementation is professionally wrong.

***Conclusion.** Verdict: implementing HRD without culture and climate analysis is likely ineffective and often harmful to trust. Diagnosis must precede design.*

Question 20 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Design a basic HRD framework for an organisation that wants to improve employee capability while aligning development efforts with organisational goals.

Introduction

Design questions need a labelled framework — boxes in words — not essays without structure. Show philosophy → strategy translation → subsystems → climate → evaluation, with roles.

Detailed points

- 1. Block 1 — Philosophy, policy and roles.** Write a short HRD policy: people development is strategic; every manager is a developer; HRD cell facilitates. Top management signs it and funds it. Without this block, later tools have no owner.
- 2. Block 2 — From organisational goals to competencies.** Take this year’s and next three years’ goals (quality, expansion, digital, customer). Translate into role competencies. This is the alignment hinge. Capability building without this block is untargeted.
- 3. Block 3 — Integrated HRD subsystems.** Performance appraisal, potential appraisal, training, career planning, feedback and counselling sharing one competency language and one employee development file.

4. Block 4 — Climate building. OCTAPAC-oriented practices, learning time, fair access. Climate is not a separate luxury; it is what makes Block 3 work.

5. Block 5 — Need diagnosis (TNA plus climate). Organisation, task, person analysis so programmes match real gaps and strategy, not vendor catalogues.

6. Block 6 — Interventions mix. OJT, formal training, mentoring, e-learning, OD for teams. Individual Development Plans reviewed against business goals; succession for critical roles.

7. Block 7 — Governance. A small HRD committee of business heads meets twice a year: are we developing the right capabilities? Line managers' KRAs include team development.

8. Block 8 — Evaluation and audit. Kirkpatrick-type measures for training, climate survey, periodic HRD audit. Feedback redesigns the framework. This closed loop is what 'basic but complete' means.

Conclusion. Present the eight blocks as your design. End: capability improves and stays aligned with goals only if strategy, subsystems, climate and evaluation sit in one framework.

UNIT 2 — HRD System and Subsystems

Question 21 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Explain the structure of an HRD system and describe its major components.

Introduction

A system is a set of parts that work together toward a purpose. An HRD system is not a training calendar hanging on a wall. It is an organised arrangement of philosophy, mechanisms, people and information that continuously develops individuals, boss-subordinate pairs, teams and the whole organisation. Structure means how those parts are arranged and linked.

Detailed points

1. Foundation — HRD philosophy and goals. At the base are beliefs that people have potential and that development is planned. Goals include individual capability, role capability, future roles, dyads, teams, collaboration and organisational health (as listed in Unit 1). If this foundation is missing, components become disconnected activities.

2. Performance appraisal. A periodic, developmental review of results and behaviours. It identifies strengths and gaps and feeds other components. In an HRD system, appraisal is not only for increment.

3. Potential appraisal. Judgement of capacity for higher or different roles. Prevents promoting people only because they are good in the present job.

4. Training and development. Planned learning to close gaps and prepare future work. Includes education and longer development, not only skill drills.

5. Career planning. A blueprint of possible paths from entry toward later roles, integrating individual aspirations with organisational needs. It is a process, not a one-time form.

6. Feedback, counselling and OD/climate. Feedback and counselling turn data into change through conversation. OD, team building and climate work develop the organisation's health — the system's outer layer.

7. Supporting structure. HRD staff, line managers as developers, information records, and links to HRM (pay, placement, promotions). Without these supports, components cannot operate.

8. Interrelation is part of structure. The structure is a network: appraisal data → counselling and TNA → training → career moves → new appraisal. Periodic check whether mechanisms help or hinder the HRD process is also structural (a review loop).

Conclusion. Define HRD as a system, list components with one function each, and stress that structure = linkage + philosophy + line ownership, not a pile of forms.

Question 22 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Explain performance appraisal as an HRD subsystem and state its importance for employee development.

Introduction

Performance appraisal as an HRD subsystem means a planned discussion of how well an employee has done, which behaviours helped or hurt, and what learning should follow. It is different from a secret mark used only to decide bonus. If appraisal does not develop the person, it is not yet an HRD subsystem — it is only an administrative ritual.

Detailed points

- 1. Meaning in HRD.** It is a cycle of role clarity, goal setting, review of results and competencies, feedback, and an individual development plan. Both boss and employee prepare. The spirit is ‘how do we improve’, not ‘how do I catch you’.
- 2. Role analysis and goals.** Development starts with knowing the job. Agreed KRAs and competency expectations make later review fair. Unclear jobs make appraisal political.
- 3. Identifying strengths and gaps.** Appraisal produces a map: what to leverage, what to train, what to coach. This map is the raw material of HRD.
- 4. Feedback institutionalised.** People cannot correct what they never hear. A yearly (and preferably more frequent) review makes feedback official, not accidental.
- 5. Development planning.** Importance is highest here: every appraisal should end with concrete actions — course, project, mentoring, job aid — and dates. Without IDP, appraisal stops at judgement.
- 6. Feeds other subsystems.** Training needs, career talks, potential reviews and counselling agendas come from appraisal. That is why it sits at the centre of many HRD systems.
- 7. Motivational and relational importance.** Fair recognition motivates. The discussion also develops the dyad (employee–boss), which Unit 1 listed as an HRD goal. A skilled appraisal conversation is itself a developmental experience.
- 8. When it fails as HRD.** Forced ranking, no counselling, surprise ratings, and no follow-up teach fear. Then appraisal harms development. Importance exists only if design is developmental.

Conclusion. Explain appraisal as a developmental cycle and list importance: clarity, diagnosis, feedback, IDP, links to training/career, motivation. End: without developmental appraisal, HRD has no regular organisation-wide engine.

Question 23 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Describe training as an HRD subsystem and explain how it contributes to employee development.

Introduction

Training is a planned organisational effort to help employees learn job-related competencies. Noe and others define it as facilitating learning of competencies needed for the job. In HRD, training is one subsystem — important, but not the whole of HRD. It contributes to development when it is need-based and supported on the job.

Detailed points

- 1. Place in the HRD system.** Training receives needs from TNA and appraisal, uses design and delivery, and returns people to work where climate and bosses must support transfer. Isolated training is an event; as subsystem it is a link in a chain.
- 2. Skill, knowledge and attitude.** Contribution is at all three levels. Example: a customer officer needs product knowledge, listening skill, and an attitude of respect. Training that only lectures facts under-develops the person.
- 3. Present-job effectiveness.** When need = standard – actual, and the cause is KSA, training raises proficiency, reduces errors and raises confidence. That is immediate development of role capability.
- 4. Preparation for change and future roles.** New machines, laws, software or supervisory roles require training before people fail in public. Development here is preventive. Combined with education, it also builds conceptual ability.
- 5. Morale and employability.** Notes list higher satisfaction, motivation, lower turnover, better image. Being trained is a signal that the organisation invests in the person — a developmental message.
- 6. Socialisation.** Induction training develops understanding of culture, rules and customers. New employees become members, not only job holders.
- 7. Limits of contribution.** Training cannot fix broken processes, bad pay, or cruel bosses. Development contribution dies if transfer climate is weak. That is why it must remain a subsystem among others.
- 8. How to maximise contribution.** TNA, clear objectives, suitable methods (OJT/off-the-job/e-learning), delivery quality, boss support, and evaluation. Then training truly develops, not entertains.

Conclusion. Describe training's definition and system place, then contributions (KSA, current job, future, morale, induction) and limits. Close: training develops employees when integrated, not when it is a picnic.

Question 24 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Explain career planning and potential appraisal as HRD subsystems.

Introduction

Both subsystems look forward. Performance appraisal mostly looks at the past year. Potential appraisal asks how far the person can go. Career planning draws the path. Together they make HRD long-term, which Unit 1 called development for expected future roles.

Detailed points

- 1. Potential appraisal — meaning.** A systematic estimate of an employee's capability to handle larger or different responsibilities. Tools may include boss reviews, assessment centres, work samples, and multiple raters. It should be separate from the performance rating so that a brilliant specialist is not automatically called a future general manager.
- 2. Potential appraisal — purpose.** Identify talent, invest development money wisely, avoid the Peter Principle (promoting people to their level of incompetence), and give employees a fair reading of organisational judgement.
- 3. Career planning — meaning.** A continuous process of selecting career goals and the path to them. Notes call it a blueprint from entry toward later years. It is a means of managing people for optimum results, not an end in

itself. Environment changes, so plans are reviewed.

4. Career planning — whose job. Primarily the individual's responsibility, but the organisation must provide information, counselling and opportunities. Goals of employees should be integrated with organisational goals.

5. Process of career planning. Identify individual needs and aspirations; analyse career opportunities in the firm; identify match and mismatch; formulate strategies (training, rotation); review. This process is itself developmental because it builds self-awareness.

6. How the two subsystems join. Potential data make career paths realistic. Career plans tell what experiences a high-potential employee needs. Without potential, career talk is wishful; without career planning, potential labels create frustration ('they said I am high potential but nothing happened').

7. Benefits. Succession, retention, better promotion quality, motivation, stable workforce, morale — as listed in career-planning notes.

8. Cautions. Secret potential lists, bias, and rigid ladders in a fast-changing firm harm HRD. Transparency (at least to the employee) and multiple career directions (specialist as well as manager) are needed.

***Conclusion.** Define each subsystem, give purpose and process, show their link, mention benefits and cautions. They are the future-oriented pair in the HRD system.*

Question 25 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Explain the role of feedback and counselling in an HRD system.

Introduction

Forms do not develop people; conversations do. Feedback gives information about behaviour and results. Counselling is a helping conversation about problems, choices and emotions, so that the employee can decide and change. In HRD they are the human process that makes appraisal, training and career systems work.

Detailed points

1. Feedback — role as information for improvement. Specific, timely, behaviour-focused information: what was effective, what was not. Example: 'In yesterday's client meeting you interrupted twice, so we missed their concern' is usable. 'You are poor' is not. Feedback reduces the gap between self-image and reality.

2. Two-way feedback. Employees also feed back on resources, unclear orders and organisational obstacles. This improves the system, not only the person, and matches the openness of HRD climate.

3. Counselling — meaning. Notes define counselling as discussion of an emotional problem with the general objective of decreasing it; also as purposeful conversation in an understanding atmosphere so the person can choose among options. It deals with communication, emotions, and decision-making. Conditions may be job dissatisfaction, resistance to change, conflict, stress, or personal issues affecting work.

4. Functions of counselling. Advise, reassure, communicate, release emotional tension, clarify thinking, reorient. Aims (Eisenberg & Delaney) include understanding self, setting achievable goals, coping, and positive self-regard. This is clearly developmental, not disciplinary scolding.

5. Link to appraisal and career. Without counselling, appraisal is a signature on a form. Career counselling prevents unrealistic hopes and maps next steps. Feedback after training helps transfer.

6. Who should counsel. Supervisors, specialists, professional counsellors. Managers need training; some cases need referral. Confidentiality is essential or the HRD system loses trust.

7. Process (simple five steps from notes). Describe changed behaviour; get employee comments; agree on a solution; summarise and get commitment; follow up. Confine negatives to performance, not character attacks.

8. Climate role. Skilled feedback and counselling build trust. Harsh or absent feedback destroys HRD climate. Thus their role is both individual development and system health.

Conclusion. Feedback informs; counselling helps the person use that information and handle emotions/choices. Together they are the heart of HRD because development happens through dialogue.

Question 26 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Describe the major principles for designing effective HRD practices.

Introduction

Principles are design rules. If you ignore them, even imported ‘best practices’ fail. Effective HRD practices are those that actually help the development process rather than hinder it with paperwork.

Detailed points

- 1. Top-management commitment.** Leaders must believe the philosophy, fund it, and model it. Practices designed by a junior trainer without CEO/owner support remain optional hobbies.
- 2. Line-manager ownership.** Design must involve and skill bosses. If only HRD staff ‘own’ appraisal or coaching, it dies when the specialist is busy.
- 3. Integration of subsystems.** Appraisal, training, career, potential and counselling must share purpose and data. Designing one practice in isolation violates systems thinking.
- 4. Strategy alignment.** Practices should build capabilities the organisation’s future needs. A beautiful leadership course is ineffective if the strategy needs technicians.
- 5. Need-based and scientific diagnosis.** Design from TNA, role analysis and climate data, not from a vendor’s brochure or a copy of a neighbour company.
- 6. Culture and climate fit.** Adapt tools to existing culture while slowly building OCTAPAC values. Principle: respect context, do not shock without safety.
- 7. Participation, fairness and transparency.** Employees should understand criteria and have voice. Equity of opportunity is both an HRD objective and a design principle.
- 8. Continuity and evaluation.** HRD process has no limit; mechanisms must be reviewed: do they promote or hinder development? Design in feedback loops (surveys, audit, Kirkpatrick).

Conclusion. List principles as headings with one example each. End: effective design is committed, line-owned, integrated, strategic, diagnosed, culture-fit, fair, and evaluated.

Question 27 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Explain how the major HRD subsystems are interrelated within an organisation.

Introduction

Interrelated means output of one is input of another. If students only list subsystems, they miss the question. Draw a cycle in words.

Detailed points

1. Appraisal to training and counselling. Gaps identified in performance appraisal become counselling topics and TNA items. If this link is cut, people are rated ‘weak in communication’ every year and never trained.

2. Training back to appraisal. After training, new behaviours should appear in the next goals and reviews. This closes the learning loop.

3. Potential to career planning. High potential → accelerated path, rotation, mentoring. Limited potential in managerial roles → specialist excellence path. Career without potential is guesswork.

4. Career to training and job experiences. A career plan specifies what to learn and which jobs to taste. Training calendars should partly come from aggregated career/IDP needs.

5. Feedback as the connecting tissue. Every subsystem needs feedback conversations. Feedback after potential review, after training, and during work keeps the system human.

6. Climate as the common context. All links fail in a fearful climate (fake data). OD and climate work therefore interrelate with every subsystem.

7. HRM links. Promotion, pay and placement must be consistent with HRD messages. If HRD says ‘collaborate’ but bonus is only individual, subsystems are contradicted from outside.

8. Information system. A shared file (competencies, IDPs, training history) makes interrelation operational. Without memory, each year starts from zero.

Conclusion. Describe a cycle: goals → performance → feedback/counselling → potential/career → training/experiences → new performance, sitting on climate and HRM consistency.

Question 28 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Explain the need for integrating HRD practices with organisational strategy.

Introduction

Strategy is the organisation’s chosen path to goals (which markets, what quality, what technology). HRD builds the people who walk that path. Integration is needed because unconnected HRD is busy but irrelevant.

Detailed points

1. Strategy is implemented by people. A plan to digitalise branches fails if staff cannot use systems and supervisors cannot coach. Capability is strategy execution.

2. Avoid irrelevant training. Without integration, popular courses eat budget while critical roles stay weak. Need is economic as well as logical.

3. Timing of talent. Strategy may need 20 new team leaders in two years. Career and potential systems must start now. Integration is about time, not only topics.

4. Culture required by strategy. Cost-leadership needs discipline and waste control; innovation needs psychological safety. HRD climate work must match the strategy type.

5. Priorities when money is limited. Strategy tells what to develop first. Integration is a rationing tool.

6. Change readiness. Strategic change creates fear. Integrated HRD (communication, training, counselling) reduces resistance. Need is change-management.

7. Credibility of HRD. When HRD shows contribution to strategic outcomes, it is funded. Isolation makes HRD the first department cut.

8. Meaning for employees. People learn better when they see why. Linking development to organisational goals increases engagement with HRD practices.

Conclusion. Need = execution of strategy, relevance, timing, culture fit, resource priority, change, credibility, and employee meaning. Unintegrated HRD is activity without impact.

Question 29 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

An organisation has an appraisal system but employees report that it does not help their development. Apply HRD principles to improve the appraisal process.

Introduction

Application: diagnose why appraisal is not developmental, then redesign using HRD principles (purpose, feedback, counselling, IDP, climate, integration, evaluation).

Detailed points

- 1. Clarify purpose in policy and talk.** State that the primary purpose is development; rewards use data but the discussion is about growth. Mixed messages ('this is for increment only') kill development.
- 2. Start with role clarity and joint goals.** If employees never agreed KRAs, review feels unfair. Principle of participation.
- 3. Train managers in evidence-based feedback.** Replace labels with incidents and impact. Principle: line managers as developers need skill.
- 4. Mandatory counselling conversation.** Protect time; ban corridor signatures. Two-way talk is the HRD heart.
- 5. End with IDP and follow-up.** Every review produces 2–3 development actions with dates, reviewed quarterly. Principle of continuity.
- 6. Link to training and career.** Gaps go to TNA; aspirations go to career talk. Principle of integration.
- 7. Climate safeguards.** Self-appraisal, no public humiliation, process appeal. Fairness principle. Fearless data is better data.
- 8. Evaluate the appraisal process itself.** Survey 'did this help my development?' Hold managers accountable for quality of conversations, not only timely forms. Principle of evaluation.

Conclusion. Show a redesign, not a new form colour. Purpose, skilled dialogue, IDP, links, climate, and evaluation convert ritual appraisal into an HRD subsystem.

Question 30 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Apply the concept of HRD subsystems to propose a development path for an employee identified as having future leadership potential.

Introduction

Do not propose only an MBA course. Use potential, career, performance, training, OJT, mentoring, feedback, counselling as a path over 2–4 years.

Detailed points

- 1. Validate potential.** Multiple inputs (boss, assessment centre, track record) so the label is fair. Wrong labels destroy careers.

2. Career map. Agree possible leadership roles in 3–5 years and the competency gap versus those roles. Individual aspirations included.

3. Keep current performance high. Leadership potential does not excuse poor present work. Appraisal includes both results and leadership behaviours (coaching, decisions, integrity).

4. Planned experiences (main developer). Job rotation, project lead, deputy assignment, cross-functional task force. Potential grows mostly through stretch work, not classroom only.

5. Training and education mix. Conceptual (strategy, finance, people) plus skills (communication, conflict). Timed just before or during stretch roles.

6. Mentor plus counselling. A senior mentor; HRD or boss counselling for transition stress and derailers (arrogance, overwork).

7. Rich feedback. 360-degree or frequent stakeholder feedback so derailers are caught early.

8. Review and organisational support. Annual potential re-check; talent council watches moves; rewards recognise development effort. If progress stalls, revise path honestly.

***Conclusion.** Present a multi-year path using all subsystems. Leadership potential becomes leadership capability only through integrated HRD, not a title.*

Question 31 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

State any two HRD subsystems.

Introduction

Name two clearly, explain each fully, then mention the rest so 8 marks are earned. Best pair: performance appraisal and training, or potential appraisal and career planning.

Detailed points

1. Subsystem 1 — Performance appraisal. Developmental review of results and behaviours to guide improvement, feedback and IDPs. It diagnoses who needs what.

2. Elaboration. As HRD (not mere rating), it includes goal setting, counselling talk, and follow-up. It feeds every other subsystem.

3. Subsystem 2 — Training. Planned learning to build job-related and future competencies. It is the most visible subsystem but must follow needs.

4. Elaboration. Contribution depends on TNA, method, delivery and transfer. Training without other subsystems often fails.

5. Other subsystems to mention. Potential appraisal, career planning, feedback and counselling, organisation development / climate mechanisms.

6. Why they are ‘sub’systems. Each is part of one HRD system with a common philosophy. Naming two is not permission to treat them as islands.

7. Interrelation example. Appraisal finds a gap → counselling agrees a plan → training builds skill → career uses the new skill → new appraisal checks behaviour.

8. Exam tip. Half the marks go to explanation and example, not to the two names.

***Conclusion.** State two, explain, list others, show a link. That is a full 8-mark ‘any two’ answer.*

Question 32 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

State any two purposes of feedback in HRD practices.

Introduction

Feedback is purposeful information, not scolding. Two core purposes: improve present performance, and support learning/development. Then add other purposes.

Detailed points

1. **Purpose 1 — Improve current performance.** Let people know where they stand against expectations so they can correct behaviour and results quickly. Without this, errors repeat.
2. **Example.** A chef told ‘salt is high in today’s gravy’ can correct tonight. A yearly remark ‘food average’ cannot.
3. **Purpose 2 — Support learning and development.** Reinforce what is going well; guide training, coaching and career choices. Feedback is how people learn from work itself — informal HRD.
4. **Motivation purpose.** Recognition through positive feedback meets higher-order needs and builds confidence.
5. **Role clarification.** Feedback reveals misunderstood expectations — a purpose linked to dyad development.
6. **Climate purpose.** Open respectful feedback signals trust and openness; it builds HRD climate.
7. **System improvement.** Upward feedback helps the organisation fix processes, tools and policies, not only people.
8. **Training evaluation.** Feedback after programmes (reaction, behaviour) improves HRD design — another purpose.

Conclusion. Two purposes: corrective (performance) and developmental (learning). Mention motivation, climate, and system improvement to complete 8 marks.

Question 33 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Analyse how poor coordination among HRD subsystems can reduce the effectiveness of employee development.

Introduction

Poor coordination means each subsystem works in a silo. Analysis: broken links → contradictory messages → wasted effort → low development effectiveness.

Detailed points

1. **Appraisal not feeding training.** Same weakness repeated yearly; employee concludes HRD is dishonest. Development stalls.
2. **Training unrelated to career.** Courses feel random; motivation to learn falls; no stretch role to practise. Transfer fails.
3. **Potential ignored in promotion.** High potentials leave; others see favouritism. Effectiveness of talent development collapses.
4. **No counselling after appraisal.** Data without insight. Forms replace development. Emotional blocks remain.
5. **Conflicting messages.** Training teaches teamwork; appraisal and bonus honour only individual targets. People follow the reward, not the classroom. Net development of collaboration is negative.

6. Duplication and gaps. Two departments run similar programmes; some roles get nothing. Inefficiency plus inequity.

7. No shared information. Each activity starts from zero; history of learning is lost. The organisation cannot manage development as a process.

8. Net effect. Employee development becomes slow, unfair, unstrategic. HRD loses credibility and budget, which further reduces effectiveness — a vicious cycle.

Conclusion. Analyse link by link, then the overall cycle of credibility loss. Coordination is not ‘nice to have’; it is a condition of HRD effectiveness.

Question 34 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Analyse how HRD practices can be aligned with organisational strategy in a rapidly changing organisation.

Introduction

Rapid change (markets, tech, structure) means alignment cannot be a five-year frozen plan. Analysis should show agile alignment methods.

Detailed points

- 1. Continuous strategy–competency translation.** Every major strategic shift updates competency maps quickly. Waiting for the next handbook is misalignment.
- 2. Shorter diagnosis cycles.** Pulse TNA and climate checks instead of rare studies. Fast change creates new gaps every quarter.
- 3. Flexible learning methods.** Blended, just-in-time, OJT, e-learning. Long residential courses only cannot keep up.
- 4. OD and change capability.** HRD facilitates new teams, mergers, culture — not only skills. Alignment includes emotional and structural change.
- 5. Talent mobility.** Career systems allow projects and lateral moves, not only rigid ladders that assume a stable hierarchy.
- 6. Line and HRD in the same meeting.** Business review includes capability risk. Alignment is a conversation rhythm, not a document.
- 7. Stopping obsolete practices.** Drop appraisal items and courses that belong to yesterday’s strategy. Alignment is also subtraction.
- 8. New success measures.** Judge HRD by speed of capability building and change readiness, not by number of programmes. What you measure is what aligns.

Conclusion. In a fast context, alignment is a repeating loop of translate–learn–review, with flexible methods and line partnership — not a static training list.

Question 35 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Evaluate the effectiveness of using potential appraisal together with performance appraisal for employee development.

Introduction

Evaluate combined use versus either alone. Judgement: more effective if methods are distinct, fair and followed by action.

Detailed points

- 1. Different questions.** Performance: how well is the present job done? Potential: how far can the person go? Mixing them in one number hides information.
- 2. Avoids wrong promotions.** Excellent specialists may fail as managers. Combined use protects both the person and the organisation — a strong effectiveness argument.
- 3. Richer development paths.** High performance + high potential → leadership track; high performance + limited managerial potential → specialist excellence; low performance + high potential → coaching and role fit. One rating cannot sort this.
- 4. Fairness and motivation.** Employees understand why stretch roles go to some people. Criteria are dual, not mysterious.
- 5. Risks that reduce effectiveness.** Secret lists, biased assessors, both judgements made in five minutes by one untrained boss, no feedback. Then combined use is political and harmful.
- 6. Conditions for effectiveness.** Separate tools/time, trained assessors, feedback to the employee, career and training actions that actually follow.
- 7. Compared with performance-only.** Performance-only HRD over-invests in today's job and under-prepares tomorrow. Combined use matches Unit 1's present-and-future role objective.
- 8. Verdict.** Highly effective for development when methodologically separated and ethically transparent; otherwise ineffective or damaging.

Conclusion. Give a clear evaluation: together is better, provided quality and action. Do not praise potential appraisal blindly.

Question 36 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Analyse how an HRD system can become ineffective when its practices are designed without organisational strategy alignment.

Introduction

Ineffectiveness means people do not gain the right capabilities, and the organisation does not gain performance or future readiness, even if HRD looks active.

Detailed points

- 1. Wrong competencies.** Staff become good at yesterday's work. Strategy needs new capabilities. Development effort is large, direction is wrong.
- 2. Misallocated budget.** Peripheral programmes flourish; critical roles stay weak. Opportunity cost is the analysis core.
- 3. Broken career promises.** Paths that do not match future structure create anger when jobs vanish or never appear. Climate suffers.
- 4. Irrelevant KRAs.** Appraisal chases old measures. People 'perform' on the wrong scorecard.
- 5. Loss of leadership support.** Business heads see no return and cut HRD. System shrinks further.

6. Cynicism and talent exit. High performers leave for firms where growth matches business. Remaining HRD audience is less capable — ineffectiveness deepens.

7. Strategy implementation failure. The organisation's own plans stall. HRD ineffectiveness becomes business ineffectiveness.

8. Illusion of success. High training days hide irrelevance until a crisis (quality failure, digital lag). Analysis must warn against activity metrics.

Conclusion. Unaligned design produces activity, broken trust, and strategic failure. Alignment is a condition of HRD effectiveness, not a decoration.

Question 37 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

State any two benefits of integrating career planning with potential appraisal.

Introduction

State two benefits in depth, then add others. Integration means career paths are based on assessed potential and potential labels lead to real career actions.

Detailed points

- 1. Benefit 1 — Realistic career paths.** Employees are not promised impossible ladders. Frustration and later 'betrayal' feelings fall. Counselling becomes truthful.
- 2. Benefit 2 — Better utilisation of talent.** High-potential people get timely stretch, rotation and training instead of waiting in a queue behind seniority only. The organisation uses its best future resource.
- 3. Succession security.** Key jobs have prepared names, not panic hiring.
- 4. Targeted investment.** Money goes where potential and organisational need meet.
- 5. Motivation and retention.** Visible fair growth paths keep capable people.
- 6. Fewer wrong promotions.** Potential qualifies career moves beyond current performance.
- 7. Better counselling quality.** Advice is evidence-based.
- 8. Exam wrap.** Two headline benefits + four supporting benefits = 8 marks.

Conclusion. Headline benefits: realistic paths and better talent utilisation. Both the person and the firm gain.

Question 38 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Mention any two features of an effective HRD practice.

Introduction

Features are qualities you would look for if asked 'is this practice effective?' Name two, explain, add more.

Detailed points

- 1. Feature 1 — Developmental purpose.** The practice helps people learn and grow; it is not only control or paperwork. Example: appraisal that ends with an IDP.
- 2. Feature 2 — Integration.** It links with other subsystems and with strategy. Example: training that comes from appraisal gaps and career plans.
- 3. Need-based.** Built on diagnosis, not fashion.

4. **Line-manager involvement.** Bosses own it daily.
5. **Fairness and transparency.** Criteria known; chances equitable.
6. **Top support and resources.** Time and money exist.
7. **Climate consistency.** Matches trust and openness; does not terrify.
8. **Evaluated and improved.** Impact reviewed; redesigned if it hinders the HRD process.

Conclusion. Two features: developmental purpose and integration. Then list diagnosis, line ownership, fairness, support, climate, evaluation.

Question 39 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Design an integrated HRD system for an organisation that wants to connect performance, potential, training, career planning, feedback, and counselling.

Introduction

Name the six elements and design the annual cycle, data spine, roles and audit. Use headings so the examiner sees a design.

Detailed points

1. **Policy architecture.** One HRD policy: these six are one cycle; line managers own; HRD facilitates; strategy committee reviews twice a year.
2. **Common language.** One competency framework and one employee development file used by all six. Without this, 'integration' is a slogan.
3. **Annual cycle (sequence).** Goal setting → ongoing feedback → performance appraisal → counselling + IDP → potential review (where relevant) → career discussion → training/experience plan → on-the-job support → evaluation → next goals.
4. **Feedback and counselling design.** Quarterly check-ins plus appraisal counselling. Managers trained. Optional professional counsellor. Confidentiality rules written.
5. **Training link.** IDPs aggregated into calendar; TNA validates group programmes; transfer tasks assigned to bosses.
6. **Potential and career governance.** Talent council uses potential data for rotations and succession, then talks to the employee — no secret forever lists without development.
7. **Role of climate.** Openness so data is honest. Fair access so the system is trusted.
8. **Audit.** Yearly: are connections felt by employees? Sample IDPs versus training attended versus career moves. Repair broken links.

Conclusion. Your design is a cycle on a shared competency spine, with trained managers, a talent council, and an audit. That connects all six.

Question 40 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Evaluate a proposed HRD practice that has strong training content but weak linkage with organisational strategy, performance appraisal, and career planning.

Introduction

Evaluate = strengths, weaknesses, likely Kirkpatrick outcomes, verdict, and what to change. Do not reject content quality; reject isolation.

Detailed points

1. **Strength of content.** Good pedagogy and experts may produce high reaction and some learning (levels 1–2). Participants may enjoy and remember concepts.
2. **Strategy weakness.** May build the wrong capabilities. Opportunity cost: seats filled by the wrong need.
3. **Appraisal disconnect.** Bosses do not expect or reinforce new behaviour. Employees return to old KRAs. Level 3 fails.
4. **Career disconnect.** Learning does not count toward growth. Motivation to apply is weak except for self-driven staff.
5. **Transfer and results risk.** Without workplace linkage, behaviour and organisational results stay poor. Strong content cannot jump this gap alone.
6. **Climate signal.** ‘Holiday training’ cynicism if work ignores the course.
7. **Conditional value.** May still help as general education for a few. As organisational HRD practice, it is weak.
8. **Verdict and redesign.** Do not accept as-is. Keep content only after remapping to strategy, inserting pre/post appraisal goals, and placing the programme on competency/career maps. Then re-evaluate.

Conclusion. Judgement: content quality is necessary but not sufficient. Without strategy, appraisal and career links, the practice is an expensive event, not HRD.

UNIT 3 — Training: TNA, Design, Methods, Evaluation

Question 41 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Explain the concept of Training Needs Assessment (TNA) and state its importance in HRD.

Introduction

Training Needs Assessment (also called Training Needs Analysis) is the systematic study of whether people need training, who needs it, and in what. A simple idea in the notes is: Training and development need = Standard performance – Actual performance — but only when the cause of the gap is lack of knowledge, skill or attitude. If the machine is broken or the target is impossible, that is not a training need. TNA is Stage 1 of the four-stage training cycle: TNA → planning/design → implementation/delivery → evaluation.

Detailed points

1. **Organisation analysis.** Check the firm’s strategies and goals, where performance problems sit, and whether the climate will support training. There must be a link between strategy and T&D. If the firm is cutting a product line, do not train extra people for it.
2. **Task analysis.** Identify important tasks and the job-related Knowledge, Skills and Attitudes (KSA) that training must emphasise so employees can complete those tasks. This produces the content outline.
3. **Person analysis.** Compare required KSAs with what each employee actually has. This answers who should sit in the programme. Not everyone with the same job title has the same gap.
4. **Importance — relevance and avoiding off-the-shelf waste.** Notes warn organisations buy ‘off the shelf’ programmes without checking applicability. TNA prevents that. HRD money and employee time are scarce.

5. Importance — correct diagnosis. Cause-and-effect analysis first: is training even the answer? TNA protects HRD's honesty and reputation.

6. Importance — design quality. Objectives, methods, level of difficulty, and examples all come from TNA. Without it, design is guesswork.

7. Importance — priority and fairness. Critical jobs and large gaps first. Person analysis also supports equity: those who need help get it, not only favourites.

8. Importance — evaluation baseline. You cannot know if training worked unless you knew the starting gap. TNA writes the success criteria that Kirkpatrick evaluation later uses.

Conclusion. Define TNA, explain three analyses, stress that not every gap is a training need, and list importance: relevance, diagnosis, design, priority, evaluation. TNA is the foundation of professional HRD training.

Question 42 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Describe the major steps involved in designing a training program.

Introduction

Design is Stage 2 of the training cycle (planning the training). A training plan describes key decisions, tasks and resources. Design converts TNA into a blueprint. If TNA is skipped, these steps decorate the wrong building.

Detailed points

- 1. Confirm needs, trainees and readiness.** Re-check TNA; ensure learners have basic skills and motivation (readiness). Unready trainees fail even good design.
- 2. Set goals and learning objectives.** Overall capability to be achieved, and specific observable objectives ('be able to do...'). Objectives drive everything else.
- 3. Select content and sequence.** What topics, in what order, theory then practice. Content must match tasks from TNA, not the trainer's favourite stories.
- 4. Choose methods and activities.** Lectures, workshops, cases, role play, OJT, e-learning, team sessions — matched to objectives (skill needs practice).
- 5. Decide location and provider.** On-the-job or off-the-job? Internal or outsourced? Inside company or off-site? These are listed in the notes as planning issues.
- 6. Plan facilities, trainers, materials, budget.** Venue, AV, handouts, meals, resource persons, costs that accounts will accept. Poor admin later looks like poor training.
- 7. Design transfer of training.** Pre-brief bosses, action plans, post-training projects, job aids. Transfer is designed, not hoped.
- 8. Build evaluation into the plan.** Reaction sheets, learning tests, behaviour follow-up, result measures agreed now. Evaluation is not an afterthought.

Conclusion. List steps in order from TNA confirmation to evaluation design. Mention the planning matrix: goal, objectives, methods, facilities, budget. Design is a plan for learning, not a timetable of speeches.

Question 43 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Explain on-the-job and off-the-job training methods with suitable examples.

Introduction

A training method is the way learning is organised. The two big families are on-the-job (learn while doing real work) and off-the-job (learn away from the daily workstation). A good 8-mark answer defines, gives examples, advantages, limitations, and says choice depends on objectives.

Detailed points

- 1. On-the-job training (OJT) — meaning.** The employee learns in the actual work setting, usually guided by a supervisor or experienced worker, using real tools and real (or carefully selected) tasks.
- 2. OJT examples.** Coaching, job rotation, apprenticeship, internship, understudy (shadowing a senior), instruction by supervisor, action-learning projects on live problems.
- 3. OJT advantages and limits.** Advantages: high relevance, cheaper extra cost, easier transfer, real context. Limits: coach may be unskilled or busy; production pressure; learning of bad habits; safety risk on dangerous machines.
- 4. Off-the-job training — meaning.** Learning away from the regular job — classroom, workshop, vestibule (simulated workplace near the factory), external institute, or conference — so attention is on learning, not output.
- 5. Off-the-job examples.** Lecture, discussion, case study, role play, management games, sensitivity training, vestibule training, simulation, outdoor/experiential programmes, formal courses.
- 6. Off-the-job advantages and limits.** Advantages: focus, expert faculty, safe practice, conceptual depth, mixing with other participants. Limits: cost, time away from work, transfer problem if classroom is unlike the job, possible irrelevance.
- 7. Comparison for the exam.** OJT is usually better for routine practical skills already present in the workplace. Off-the-job is better for new concepts, dangerous tasks, and when the workplace itself teaches the wrong method.
- 8. HRD view — blend.** Most development programmes should combine both: concept off-the-job, skill on-the-job, with coaching. Method is a servant of TNA objectives.

Conclusion. Define both, give 3 examples each, one advantage and one limit each, and conclude that HRD blends methods according to the need.

Question 44 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Explain e-learning as a training method and state its major advantages.

Introduction

E-learning is training delivered through electronic media: learning management systems (LMS), online modules, virtual classrooms, webinars, and mobile learning. It may be self-paced or live (synchronous). It can stand alone or be blended with classroom and OJT. 21st-century HRD notes mention web-based training, mobile devices, webinars and social learning tools.

Detailed points

- 1. Nature of the method.** Digital content (text, video, quizzes, simulations) plus often tracking of who completed what. Good e-learning is instructional design, not PDF dumping.
- 2. Advantage — flexibility of time and place.** Staff on shifts or in many cities can learn without travel. Useful in India for multi-location firms.
- 3. Advantage — speed and scale.** The same compliance or product-update module can reach thousands quickly and consistently.

4. Advantage — cost over time. High design cost at first; low cost per extra learner later. Repeat training becomes cheaper.

5. Advantage — standardisation and tracking. Quality does not depend on whichever local trainer is free. LMS records scores and completion for evaluation and audit.

6. Advantage — personalisation and replay. Learners repeat difficult parts; adaptive paths; micro-learning of 10 minutes. This helps mixed-ability groups.

7. Advantage — blending and 21st-century tools. Can combine with webinars, mobile apps, wikis, communities of practice. Notes also mention 3D activities and social learning.

8. Limitations (to show balance). Needs devices, connectivity, self-discipline, and good design. Weak for some interpersonal skills unless combined with role play. Transfer still needs boss support. Mention limits so the answer is not one-sided.

***Conclusion.** Define e-learning, list advantages (flexibility, scale, cost, consistency, tracking, personalisation, blending), add two limits, conclude it is powerful when designed and supported, not when it is only video lectures.*

Question 45 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Explain the Kirkpatrick model for evaluating training effectiveness.

Introduction

Donald Kirkpatrick's model is the most famous framework for judging whether training worked. It has four levels, usually seen as a ladder: each level is more difficult to measure and more important for the organisation. The training cycle's Stage 4 (evaluation) often uses this model. Outcomes must be related to the objectives of the programme.

Detailed points

1. Level 1 — Reaction (affective outcomes). Did participants like the programme? Was it relevant, comfortable, well trained? Measured by feedback forms ('smile sheets'). Useful for improving hospitality and trainer style, but liking is not learning.

2. Level 2 — Learning. Did they gain the intended knowledge, skill or attitude? Measured by tests, demonstrations, pre-post comparison, role-play scores. If level 2 is weak, later levels cannot honestly succeed.

3. Level 3 — Behaviour (transfer). Do they use it on the job after some time? Measured by observation, supervisor ratings, 360 feedback, work samples. This is where most programmes die because climate and bosses do not support new behaviour.

4. Level 4 — Results. Did the organisation benefit — quality, productivity, errors, sales, safety, customer satisfaction, costs? Notes also say impact on corporate objectives. Hard to prove cause, but this is why the company paid.

5. Logic of the hierarchy. Good reaction helps learning; learning is needed for behaviour; behaviour should produce results. But each step can fail even if the previous succeeded. Therefore all levels matter.

6. Design implication. Decide measures during TNA and design, not after the valedictory function. Collect baseline (before training) for levels 2–4.

7. Importance for HRD. Stops HRD from claiming success on attendance and tea quality. Raises professionalism.

8. Limitations. Causality at level 4 is messy; not all outcomes are numeric; full four-level evaluation is costly — use proportionately (critical safety training vs a one-hour talk). Still the best simple map of effectiveness.

Conclusion. Name and explain four levels with measures, state the ladder logic, mention design and limits. Kirkpatrick asks: not only ‘did they enjoy?’ but ‘did they learn, do, and improve results?’

Question 46 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Describe the importance of delivering a training program effectively after it has been designed.

Introduction

Delivery (implementation) is Stage 3: putting the plan into effect. Notes split it into practical administrative arrangements and actually carrying out the training. A brilliant design on paper can fail in a noisy hall with an unprepared trainer. Importance of delivery is that learning happens here, not in the file.

Detailed points

- 1. Learning occurs at delivery.** Objectives are achieved only if explanation, practice, feedback and timing actually happen. Delivery is the product students experience.
- 2. Administrative arrangements matter.** Venue, seating, projection, handouts, travel, batch size, food, IT login for e-modules. Discomfort and chaos steal attention and show disrespect, lowering reaction and learning.
- 3. Trainer competence.** Subject knowledge plus adult-learning skill (questions, examples, respect). A poor trainer can make correct content unusable.
- 4. Adaptation in the room.** Effective delivery adjusts pace to the group without abandoning objectives. Rigid reading of slides is not delivery.
- 5. Psychological climate of the classroom.** Safety to practise, make mistakes, and ask ‘silly’ questions. Especially for skills and attitude training.
- 6. Starting transfer during delivery.** Action plans, boss invited to closing, practice on real cases from their department. If delivery is only theory, transfer is postponed forever.
- 7. Motivation opening and closing.** Why this training, what will be expected at work, what support exists. Delivery frames meaning.
- 8. Evaluation data collected here.** Tests and reaction forms. Sloppy implementation yields unusable evaluation, so the cycle breaks.

Conclusion. Design is the recipe; delivery is the cooking. Importance: actual learning, admin, trainer, climate, transfer start, motivation, evaluation. HRD impact depends on how the programme is carried out.

Question 47 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Explain the relationship among Training Needs Assessment, training design, training delivery, and training evaluation.

Introduction

These are the four stages of the training cycle in the notes. Relationship is sequential and circular: each feeds the next, and evaluation feeds back to TNA and design. They are one process of planned learning (Nadler: organised learning for behavioural change).

Detailed points

- 1. TNA → Design.** Gaps, who, constraints, and whether training is the solution become objectives, content, methods, budget.

2. Design → Delivery. The plan (sequence, methods, facilities, transfer tasks) guides implementation. Delivery without design is improvisation; design without delivery is a document.

3. Delivery → Evaluation. Implementation produces experiences and evidence (tests, behaviour later). You evaluate what was actually delivered, not what was hoped.

4. Evaluation → TNA. Remaining gaps, wrong diagnoses, new needs restart the cycle. Training is continuous in HRD, not a one-shot.

5. Evaluation → Design/Delivery. Poor learning → redesign content/method. Poor reaction → trainer or admin. Poor behaviour → transfer/climate, not only slides.

6. If TNA is skipped. Design aims at the wrong target; evaluation cannot define success. The whole chain is poisoned at the source.

7. If evaluation is skipped. Open loop: the organisation never learns whether delivery was worth it. Next TNA is again guesswork.

8. HRD implication. Professionals must budget time for all four, not only the visible classroom day. Relationship is a cycle of quality.

Conclusion. Draw the cycle: TNA → design → delivery → evaluation → back to TNA. Explain each arrow. Breaking any link reduces training to an event.

Question 48 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Discuss the importance of evaluating training effectiveness for employees and organisations.

Introduction

Evaluation asks whether objectives were met. It is Stage 4 and a duty of HRD. Importance differs slightly for employees (learning and career) and organisations (accountability and improvement), but both need the truth, not only certificates.

Detailed points

1. For employees — knowledge of progress. Tests and coaching after training show what was mastered and what to practise. This is feedback, an HRD right.

2. For employees — career evidence. Documented competence supports growth talks and internal mobility.

3. For employees — better future learning. Their reaction and suggestions improve later programmes. They are stakeholders, not passengers.

4. For organisations — accountability. Training uses money and lost production time. Managers must know return. Notes: effectiveness valued against outcomes related to objectives.

5. For organisations — improvement of HRD. Evaluation locates whether failure was need, design, delivery or transfer. Without it, the same bad course repeats.

6. For organisations — strategy. Level 4 data show if capability for strategy increased. That is why HRD claims strategic status.

7. Avoiding illusions. Happy participants may not perform. Evaluation prevents false security. Also avoids false failure (strict trainer, high learning).

8. Credibility of the HRD function. Systematic evaluation moves HRD from ‘cost centre that arranges picnics’ to a professional function. That importance is political as well as technical.

***Conclusion.** Split importance: employees (feedback, career, voice) and organisation (accountability, improvement, strategy, truth, HRD credibility). Evaluation protects both development quality and investment.*

Question 49 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

A department is experiencing repeated performance errors. Apply the concept of TNA to identify what information should be collected before designing training.

Introduction

Application of TNA: do not jump to a workshop. Collect organisation, task and person information, and test non-training causes. List the information under headings.

Detailed points

- 1. Error facts (not opinions).** Type of error, frequency, process step, shift, product, cost. Interview plus records. Without facts, TNA is gossip.
- 2. Organisation analysis information.** Department goals, quality standards, staffing, whether supervisors support correct methods, recent changes (new machine, new target). Strategy link: is speed being rewarded over accuracy?
- 3. Non-training causes.** Machine condition, unclear SOP, missing tools, impossible workload, incentive to rush. Notes: training is not the answer to all problems; cause-and-effect first. If these dominate, design a process fix, not training.
- 4. Task analysis information.** Correct procedure, critical KSAs, safety points, standard of error-free work, difficult steps where errors cluster.
- 5. Person analysis information.** Who errs (new joiners vs veterans), previous training, language/literacy, actual vs required skill tests, ‘knows but doesn’t do’ versus ‘doesn’t know’.
- 6. Readiness and motivation.** Do employees believe errors matter? Are they afraid to report? Will they be punished for slowing down to be correct?
- 7. Transfer climate information.** Will the boss allow correct slower practice after training? Peer pressure? Old informal methods?
- 8. Success criteria for later evaluation.** What error reduction in 8 weeks would mean success? Collect baseline now. This information is part of TNA, not later.

***Conclusion.** Information list: error data, organisation context, non-training causes, task KSAs, person gaps, readiness, transfer climate, baseline. Only then design training — if training is the right answer.*

Question 50 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Apply suitable training methods to design a development program for employees who need both practical job skills and conceptual knowledge.

Introduction

When both ‘hand’ and ‘head’ are needed, one method is not enough. Design a blend: off-the-job or e-learning for concepts; simulation then OJT for skills; evaluation of both.

Detailed points

- 1. Start with TNA split.** List conceptual objectives (explain why, standards, theory) separately from practical objectives (perform the task to standard). Methods follow this split.

2. Conceptual methods. Short lectures, discussion, cases, e-modules, diagrams. Example: why a safety lock exists, not only how to click it.

3. Safe practice methods. Vestibule, simulation, role play, lab. Mistakes do not harm customers or machines. Bridge between concept and live work.

4. OJT coaching and rotation. Real skill under a trained coach with a checklist. Job rotation if multiple practical contexts exist.

5. Action learning project. A live problem where they must use concepts to decide and skills to implement. This binds both needs.

6. E-learning refreshers. Micro-modules for concepts they can repeat after OJT. Supports memory.

7. Sequence. Concept → simulated practice → OJT → review. Starting with unsupervised OJT may freeze wrong methods.

8. Evaluation of both. Knowledge tests (level 2 conceptual) and observed job samples (level 3 practical). If you only test memory, practical skill may still be weak.

Conclusion. Present a blended design with sequence and evaluation. Suitable methods are a mix, not a single favourite of the trainer.

Question 51 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

State any two purposes of Training Needs Assessment.

Introduction

Two main purposes: identify genuine training needs, and avoid training as a wrong solution. Then add design, priority, baseline purposes.

Detailed points

- 1. Purpose 1 — Identify genuine KSA gaps.** Using organisation, task and person analysis, find what learning is required and by whom.
- 2. Purpose 2 — Prevent wrong solutions.** Detect system, tool, or motivation problems so the firm does not buy irrelevant training. Notes' caveat: training is not the answer to all problems.
- 3. Set measurable objectives.** TNA gives learning and performance objectives for design.
- 4. Select the right trainees.** Not everyone needs the same programme — fairness and efficiency.
- 5. Guide method choice.** Skill vs knowledge vs attitude needs different methods.
- 6. Prioritise scarce resources.** Critical jobs and large gaps first.
- 7. Create evaluation baseline.** Pre-training performance recorded.
- 8. Align with strategy.** Organisation analysis keeps HRD relevant to goals.

Conclusion. Two purposes: find real training needs; stop false training. Other purposes fill the 8 marks.

Question 52 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Name any two levels of the Kirkpatrick model.

Introduction

Name any two, explain all four briefly for marks, and say why more than two levels matter.

Detailed points

1. **Level 1 — Reaction.** Satisfaction and perceived usefulness. Forms at the end of the programme.
2. **Level 2 — Learning.** Increase in knowledge, skill or attitude. Tests and demonstrations.
3. **Level 3 — Behaviour.** Transfer to the job after a lag. Observation and boss ratings.
4. **Level 4 — Results.** Organisational outcomes: quality, cost, safety, customer, etc.
5. **Why name more than two in an 8-mark answer.** The question says two; the syllabus expects the model. Write two in detail and the other two in brief.
6. **Measurement examples.** Smile sheet; pre–post test; 60-day audit; defect rate vs baseline.
7. **Sequence.** Each level supports but does not guarantee the next.
8. **HRD use.** Important costly programmes should not stop at reaction.

Conclusion. Any two named in depth + remaining two in brief = full answer. Never leave Kirkpatrick as only two words.

Question 53 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Analyse why a training program may receive positive participant reactions but still fail to improve job performance.

Introduction

This is the gap between Kirkpatrick level 1 and levels 3–4. Analyse reasons in the programme, the person, and the workplace.

Detailed points

1. **Entertainment versus learning.** Funny trainer, good food, hill-station venue raise reaction. Skill may not have been practised. Level 2 never happened.
2. **Learning without difficulty.** Content too easy or too theoretical; people leave happy and incompetent.
3. **Wrong need (TNA missing).** Performance problem was tools, process, or target, not skill. Training cannot improve job performance then, however pleasant.
4. **No transfer climate.** Boss says ‘forget the classroom’. Peers mock new methods. Old SOP remains. Behaviour cannot change.
5. **No opportunity to use.** Skill unused for months is forgotten. Reaction was real; performance chance never came.
6. **Conflicting appraisal and rewards.** Taught quality; paid for speed. People follow pay. Analysis: systems beat training.
7. **No follow-up coaching.** One event without IDP, refreshers, or supervisor support. Decay of learning.
8. **Analytical conclusion.** Reaction is a weak predictor of job performance. HRD must design for learning, transfer support and results, not applause.

Conclusion. Give workplace and design reasons, not only ‘they were happy’. Close with the level-1 versus level-3 lesson.

Question 54 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Analyse the consequences of designing a training program without conducting an adequate Training Needs Assessment.

Introduction

Consequences are operational, financial, human and strategic. Analyse cause (no TNA) to these effects.

Detailed points

- 1. Wrong content.** Topics miss actual KSA gaps; errors continue. The original problem remains.
- 2. Wrong audience.** Skilled staff bored; needy staff absent. Reaction may even be negative from the bored group.
- 3. Wrong method.** Lecture where coaching was needed. Learning and transfer fail.
- 4. Training as false solution.** System problems remain; management thinks ‘we already trained them’ and stops looking. This is a dangerous consequence.
- 5. Demotivation and HRD cynicism.** Employees lose faith; future programmes suffer attendance of the mind.
- 6. Wasted budget and lost production time.** Direct cost plus opportunity cost. In exams, mention both.
- 7. Impossible honest evaluation.** No baseline or true objectives, so anyone can claim success or failure. The cycle cannot learn.
- 8. Strategic drift.** Calendar becomes ritual, disconnected from goals. Long-term capability lag.

Conclusion. Consequences cascade from wrong design to wasted money, cynicism and unsolved performance problems. Adequate TNA is professional risk control, not extra paperwork.

Question 55 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Evaluate the usefulness of the Kirkpatrick model for judging the effectiveness of an organisational training program.

Introduction

Evaluate usefulness + limitations + how to use it well. Verdict: useful guiding framework, not a perfect scientific proof.

Detailed points

- 1. Usefulness — completeness.** Forces HRD beyond smile sheets to learning, behaviour and results. Matches notes’ criteria: learning, behaviour, impact on objectives.
- 2. Usefulness — communication.** Four levels are easy to explain to managers who fund training.
- 3. Usefulness — design aid.** Encourages measures during TNA. Makes objectives operational.
- 4. Usefulness — diagnosis.** If reaction high and behaviour low, look at transfer climate, not only the trainer. The model locates the break.
- 5. Limitation — causality at level 4.** Many factors affect results. Training may be only one. Do not over-claim.
- 6. Limitation — cost and time.** Behaviour and results need follow-up. Firms may stop at level 1; the model is then unused, not useless.
- 7. Limitation — one size.** A one-hour awareness talk does not need full level 4. Use proportionately.

8. Verdict. Highly useful if applied with judgement and transfer thinking; weak if treated as four forms to file. Still the standard HRD evaluation map.

***Conclusion.** Balanced evaluation, clear usefulness, honest limits, proportionate use. Recommend Kirkpatrick as a guide, not a ritual.*

Question 56 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Analyse how the choice among on-the-job, off-the-job, and e-learning methods can affect training outcomes.

Introduction

Method choice affects learning quality, transfer, cost, motivation and therefore Kirkpatrick outcomes. Analyse each method's outcome pattern and the idea of fit.

Detailed points

- 1. OJT outcome pattern.** Strong transfer and relevance (good level 3 if coaching is skilled). Weak if the coach is busy or teaches wrong methods — then outcomes are bad habits at scale.
- 2. Off-the-job outcome pattern.** Better conceptual learning and safe practice (level 2). Level 3 suffers if work does not resemble the classroom. High cost may be justified for dangerous or new skills.
- 3. E-learning outcome pattern.** Consistent knowledge, tracking, scale (good for level 2 information). Weak completion, isolation, or poor design destroy even level 1–2. Interpersonal skills usually need extra live practice.
- 4. Fit to objective.** Motor skill → OJT/simulation; interpersonal → role play; information update → e-learning. Wrong fit lowers outcomes regardless of budget.
- 5. Learner factors.** New employees may need structured off-the-job; experienced staff may prefer OJT or micro e-learning. Mismatch reduces motivation and learning.
- 6. Blended outcomes.** Combining methods often beats any single method: concept + practice + job support.
- 7. Climate interaction.** Any method fails if workplace punishes new behaviour. Method analysis must include transfer context.
- 8. Analytical point.** Outcomes are not determined by the label 'OJT' or 'e-learning' but by fit, quality of execution, and support. Choice is a strategic HRD decision.

***Conclusion.** Analyse each method's typical strengths/failures, then fit, blend, and climate. Method choice shapes whether training stays in the head or appears in job performance.*

Question 57 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

State any two reasons for evaluating training at more than one Kirkpatrick level.

Introduction

Two main reasons: different questions, and diagnosis of where the chain broke. Then extra reasons for 8 marks.

Detailed points

- 1. Reason 1 — Different levels answer different questions.** Liking ≠ learning ≠ doing ≠ business results. One level cannot stand for effectiveness.

2. **Reason 2 — Diagnosis of failure.** Multi-level data show whether to fix content, trainer, transfer climate, or job conditions.
3. **Accountability.** Organisations fund performance, not entertainment.
4. **Employee development.** Learning and behaviour data guide further coaching.
5. **Avoid false positives.** High reaction can hide zero performance change.
6. **Avoid false negatives.** Low reaction (strict trainer) might still mean high learning — need level 2.
7. **Continuous improvement.** Each level suggests different redesign.
8. **Strategic HRD.** Only higher levels show contribution to goals.

Conclusion. Two reasons: different questions and diagnosis. Add accountability and avoiding false success. Multi-level evaluation is how HRD tells the truth.

Question 58 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Mention any two factors that should be considered while selecting a training method.

Introduction

Two headline factors: learning objectives, and nature of the task. Then list others (trainee, cost, location, culture).

Detailed points

1. **Factor 1 — Learning objectives.** Knowledge, skill or attitude demand different methods. You cannot lecture people into a motor skill or only e-read them into counselling skill.
2. **Factor 2 — Nature of the job/task.** Dangerous or costly tasks need simulation/off-the-job first. Simple routine skills may use OJT. Customer-facing tasks need practice with feedback.
3. **Trainee characteristics.** Education, experience, language, digital literacy, motivation, number of people.
4. **Cost, time, production loss.** Budget and whether staff can leave the workplace.
5. **Geography and numbers.** Scattered staff → e-learning or travelling trainer.
6. **Trainer and facility availability.** Internal expert vs vendor; lab vs classroom.
7. **Transfer requirements.** How soon must the skill appear on the job? Urgent skill → OJT with coach.
8. **Organisational culture and climate.** Will role play or open discussion be accepted? Culture-blind method choice fails.

Conclusion. Two factors: objectives and task nature. Then trainee, cost, location, transfer, culture. Method selection must be systematic.

Question 59 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Design a complete training program for a clearly identified employee skill gap, covering TNA, objectives, training method, delivery, and evaluation.

Introduction

Pick a clear gap so the design is concrete. Example used here: customer-service staff have a skill gap in handling complaints (repeat complaints high, first-contact resolution low). You may use another gap if you prefer, but cover

all five required parts.

Detailed points

- 1. TNA.** Organisation: customer-retention strategy. Task: complaint process, empathy, CRM logging, escalation rules. Person: who fails — new vs old; knowledge vs skill vs attitude. Check IT and policy: if software is down, do not train. Baseline: repeat-complaint % and CSAT.
- 2. Objectives.** By end of classroom, trainee can listen, log, resolve or escalate per SOP in a role play. Within 8 weeks, repeat complaints fall by an agreed percentage. Write objectives in observable language.
- 3. Training method (blend).** E-module on policy (concept); classroom role play with recorded calls (skill); two weeks OJT coaching with checklist (transfer).
- 4. Delivery.** Batches of about 12; skilled facilitator; CRM practice lab; manager present at close to commit support. Admin: working logins, quiet room, handouts of SOP. Action plan signed.
- 5. Transfer support.** Supervisor weekly coaching; appraisal KRA on resolution quality; job aid near the phone.
- 6. Evaluation L1–L2.** Reaction form; knowledge test; observed role play score vs checklist.
- 7. Evaluation L3–L4.** Call audits at 30 and 60 days; repeat-complaint and CSAT versus baseline. Compare a trained group with untrained if possible.
- 8. Review meeting.** HRD and department head at 60 days: refine SOP or coaching if results lag. This makes the design a cycle, not a one-day event.

Conclusion. Show all parts on one example. A complete programme is TNA-based, objective-led, blended, well delivered, transfer-supported, and evaluated at several Kirkpatrick levels.

Question 60 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Evaluate two alternative training programs for the same organisational need using the Kirkpatrick model and recommend the more effective program.

Introduction

Need: first-line supervisors must learn to give developmental feedback (HRD climate). Compare Programme A (glamorous but shallow) and Programme B (TNA-based blended). Evaluate each level, then recommend.

Detailed points

- 1. Programme A described.** Two-day off-site ‘leadership’ with a motivational speaker, little practice, no boss involvement, no follow-up.
- 2. Programme B described.** TNA-based: concept module, extensive role play, real feedback assignments, boss-as-coach, 60-day follow-up, appraisal item on coaching quality.
- 3. Level 1 Reaction.** A may score higher (venue, speaker). B adequate if seen as relevant. Reaction would wrongly pick A.
- 4. Level 2 Learning.** B superior: practice and feedback on the actual skill. A may give quotes, not skill.
- 5. Level 3 Behaviour.** B superior: assignments and workplace support. A rarely transfers.
- 6. Level 4 Results.** B more likely to improve climate, error correction, engagement. A is costly with little result.
- 7. Recommendation.** Choose B even if smile sheets are slightly lower. Effectiveness in HRD is behaviour and results, not applause.

8. Condition and evaluation honesty. B still fails at level 3 without management support. Recommendation includes that condition. Do not implement A merely because it is popular.

Conclusion. *Using Kirkpatrick, recommend the programme that can reach levels 3 and 4. State that level 1 alone would mislead the organisation into buying Programme A.*